

K T M O R R I S O N

REZA'S GAME

DOMINATED BY THEIR LANDLORD



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KT MORRISON

CONTENTS

[About the Author](#)

[Also by KT Morrison](#)

[Chapter 1](#)

[Chapter 2](#)

[Chapter 3](#)

[Chapter 4](#)

[Chapter 5](#)

[Chapter 6](#)

[Chapter 7](#)

[Chapter 8](#)

[Chapter 9](#)

[Chapter 10](#)

[Chapter 11](#)

[Chapter 12](#)

[Chapter 13](#)

[Chapter 14](#)

[Afterword](#)

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

KT Morrison writes stories about women who fall in love with sexy men who aren't their husband, and loving relationships that go too far—couples who open a mysterious door, then struggle to get it closed as trouble pushes through the threshold.

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Models on cover are meant for illustrative purposes only.

All characters are over the age of eighteen.

REZA'S GAME

A LANDLORD novel

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CHAPTER ONE

GATHERED around his feet under the desk were three recently empty cans of Wildcat Energy Drink. The big ones. Acid burned a bright spot the size of a quarter in the center of his chest. How many hours straight had he been awake now?—it was fuzzy. As his fingers danced on the keyboard, banging out code by rote, he calculated. It was almost six in the morning now; the sun turning the night sky a deep navy. He'd been awake since this time yesterday—that was twenty-four hours. Before that, when had he slept? Day before yesterday? Seemed about right. Day before yesterday, in the sunny afternoon, he'd collapsed from exhaustion. Not on the couch or the bed, but the floor. Fell asleep for maybe two hours. Before that though, it might have been forty-eight hours he'd gone without sleep.

It was paying off. What he had created—was still creating—was good. Really good. He'd show Reza, make him eat his words. Most importantly?—he'd make Charlie proud.

While it was paying off, there was an apparent problem. Time. There were only so many hours in a day and his basic milestone calculations showed him he'd be working eight months before he was even ready for a beta, let alone a release. He could hire help, but he had no money, and his rep in the business, even in the business's underground, wasn't good. No

one would trust him for back-end and he couldn't pay them up front. He was screwed.

But sleepless nights helped him get closer. It was like he was working three full-time shifts. Sure, it helped with the mechanics, the straightforward tasks of making his game, but sometimes he thought the longer he stayed awake the fuzzier the big picture became. But what could he do?—Work his ass off overtime, that's what.

Behind him lay the reason he would kill himself doing this. His beautiful Charlie slept in a king-size bed with a human gorilla.

Around three this morning Reza had been snoring up a storm—literally sounding like a cartoon bear; and not a friendly one, but a fierce one that, like, Bugs Bunny or whatever would be afraid to wake. On and on it went, and he turned around and saw in the bright light from his monitor, Reza and Charlie curled up in bed together. They spooned; Reza the big spoon, one hairy and tattooed arm draped over the little redheaded spoon. Charlie's eyes were open and as Reza roared behind her again, they opened wide and the two of them both shared a silent laugh. He'd gone then to the bathroom and wadded up squares of toilet paper into makeshift earplugs. He brought them to Charlie and she let him tuck them into her tiny ear holes, still held in her landlord's clutch. When she kissed his wrist while he did it his heart just about burst. He stood at the side of the bed for a long moment making eye contact with her. Both of them stifling smiles as Reza continued to snore. He kissed her forehead, and she closed her eyes.

Before bed, before the snoring, Reza had fucked her. Took her from behind this time and Jonny watched from his desk using a small cosmetic mirror on a plastic stand. He hated to watch, but he also liked to watch. And if he watched while he worked it tended to put nitrous in his system, get his sore fingers typing faster. So while he faced his monitor and hashed code, he could also see his thin wife on her elbows and knees, Reza with a good

grip on her narrow waist, banging her so hard from behind her skinny thighs shook.

Eventually Charlie came, crying that reluctant shameful sound she made when their landlord made her come. It was at the tail end of Charlie's worst window in her cycle, and astonishingly for three days Reza had used a condom with her. He liked danger he said, but he didn't think sure-things were sexy, saying if he came inside her conception would be assured. You know, due to his fertility and virility. It was hard to find a bright spot in their sexual submission to their powerful master but his magnanimity was welcome when they found it, which was rare.

There were *other* perks, of course. Charlie slept in a big comfortable king-size bed and was getting better sleep she told him, when Reza wasn't snoring. To his left was a sixty-inch 4K TV, and they had a full subscription to every channel. At least Charlie got to enjoy it, watching from the couch while he still worked. Jonny hadn't taken a break to sit with her and watch in days. It was still nice just the same to have it on and be in the same room with her while she did. And the fridge was always fully stocked. Meat, vegetables, fruits, cheeses, great snacks, and alcohol, too. Many evenings, before Reza came home, Charlie would lay on the couch behind him, watching TV and calling him to look how round her belly was. Laughing then when he looked over, and she made it balloon out, then complaining how she was eating too much. All in all though, it would seem, that Charlie, despite her griping, was receiving great benefit from the arrangement and he hated to think that. Reza had taken her out for dinner twice, he had Tate driving her to and from work every day, no more public transportation. At home she was being pampered with comforts. And even though she seemed to grumble about sleeping with their well-hung landlord, he had her coming all over his cock, sweating and crying, clutching at the bed sheets. But it was selfish and petty to think of Charlie like that. She was good. She was

his wife, and she loved him. This was hard on her and it was a sacrifice she made for them.

And he couldn't wait to win this game, see Reza's face when he took Charlie back. Couldn't wait to see Charlie's face, too—he'd let her down a lot recently, it was going to be great to remind her why she married him.

THERE WAS STIRRING behind him now as the room filled with dawning gray light. One hand still typing, his other reached out to nudge the corner of the mirror's stand and angle it so its circular face filled with Reza and Charlie laying in bed together. They still spooned, but both were awake and Reza grumbled something in Charlie's ear. She reached under her mane and tugged out wadded up paper.

Reza grumbled again near her ear and she nodded, turned around under the covers to face him. She wore a royal blue T-shirt to sleep in and it complemented her shaggy apricot hair. Reza's hand caressed her back, and she kissed his hairy chest. This was nothing new. Reza liked to get a hand job or blowjob when he woke up.

Charlie kissed her way down his stomach muscles, disappearing under the sheets. Reza pulled them back to reveal her, him making eye contact with Jonny in the mirror, knowing he watched. His cock was semi-stiff, flopped up on his stomach, engorged but not squiggled yet with veins. Charlie kissed her way around it, getting both her knees between Reza's outstretched muscular legs. Her lips smacked and sucked to his hip bone then along the line that ran from hip to crotch, settling herself low on the bed, her pointed tongue swirling designs over his fat testicles, lifting them and letting them sag again.

Jonny tried to work, but it was distracting—and he'd also grown painfully hard. Charlie's mouth made soft wet sounds suckling on Reza's scrotum and Jonny's fingers stopped typing, eyes glued to the awful action

playing out in the mirror. His wife's hand cradled Reza's cock now while she sucked one large ball past her pouted lips. She stroked the underside of it with the pad of her thumb. Reza groaned a little, made himself more comfortable.

Charlie stroked him, her hand making clumsy up-and-down motions, her grip struggling with his girth. Reza grew hard, his cock lengthening, foreskin remaining covered even though Charlie stroked him without any kind of lubrication. Once he was fully erect, he caught Jonny's eye in the mirror again and this time he smiled.

Jonny got back to work. Focus was difficult with Charlie's mouth sounds but he did his best not to look over. Once in a while he couldn't help it, and every time was the same: Charlie down between his open legs, sucking his balls, gently stroking his cock and rubbing it with her thumb. Jonny's own cock absolutely—painfully—throbbed.

It went on for twenty minutes. After twelve minutes every time the digital clock on his monitor flipped over another minute he would think *Oh, come on*. At the twenty-minute mark, Reza's breaths took on a deep and desperate pace. Now Jonny watched again, Reza's eyes closed as he came close to orgasm.

Charlie still sucked on his balls. It must hurt by now even if she was careful. Maybe Reza liked a little hurt in his testicles. It did seem to get him off, his stomach flattening and then billowing, his breaths coming short and raspy. Reza reached down and took Charlie's hand and helped her fingers to pinch closed his thick foreskin. Then he was grunting and thrusting his hips, snorting through his nostrils while Charlie sucked in one of his balls yet again.

A long, thin line of semen darted onto his chest despite Charlie holding his foreskin closed, but her hand scrambled, knuckling up his thick folds and stopping more from escaping. Jonny watched the foreskin swell and

bulge as his cock pumped his thick copious seed into it. Charlie's breaths sounded lusty as well, her with a testicle clamped in her mouth.

When his orgasm abated, and he stopped writhing on the bed, Reza held her wrist and motioned for her to come up his body. Charlie gave a quick glance over her shoulder, her expression fearful—and she caught him watching her. Now she angled her body so Jonny wouldn't see what he knew she was about to do.

She straddled one of Reza's thighs and Jonny got a direct view of her cute white butt bent over and pointed right at him behind her pink and white striped cotton panties. Her ginger hair shook a little as her head bobbed over Reza's cock and he knew she'd just let out all that goo into her mouth.

Reza chuckled with appreciation, stroking her hair, cupping the back of her head. The first time he'd come in her mouth, oh-so-long-ago, she'd retched in the toilet, rinsed with bleach. She was getting a little better, but it still wasn't her favorite thing. Reza produced a large volume, and she always complained to him secretly.

With jerky careful movement, she rose up off him, got to her knees and turned, getting off the bed and heading to the bathroom. She hid her face from Jonny, but in the moment before she disappeared and locked herself in the bathroom, he saw her red-faced, one hand clamped over her mouth. In the bathroom, he heard her spitting into the sink, running the water full blast then the sounds of her brushing her teeth.

Reza still smiled at him from the mirror and he looked back to the monitor and got back to working. Charlie tinkled then flushed, came back out and walked to his side.

“Good morning,” she whispered.

“Morning, baby,” he said to her, looking up at her sweet, angel face, tugging his T-shirt to conceal his erection pressing his pants out. She dipped her smiling lips to meet his, and they kissed. He bit and sucked at her, and

she giggled in his mouth—just mouthwash and toothpaste, no evidence of Reza on her breath.

“You sleep okay?” he asked her when they parted.

“Sometimes,” she whispered, her tone cynical, the two of them sharing a joke together at Reza’s expense.

She looked at his monitors just showing a bunch of overlapping consoles; boring old code stuff. “How’s it going?”

“I’m on fire, Charlie, I mean it.”

“It’s good?”

“So good, Charlie.”

“I knew it would be, Jonny,” she said, kissed the top of his head. He hooked an arm around her waist and hugged his cheek to her hip.

“It’s a lot of work,” he said quietly.

“You stayed up all night again?”

“Yeah,” he said.

“Jonny, you can’t do that every night. You’ll kill yourself.”

“I have to, Charlie. I have to get us out of this.”

“You can’t if you’re dead, Jonny. You keep drinking these,” she said, nudging one of his empty energy drink cans with her toes, “you’re going to have a heart attack.”

“I have to keep going when I got the inspiration.”

Now she squatted down so they were eye-to-eye and cupped his cheeks in her palms. “Promise me, Jonny—promise me you’ll get some sleep today.”

“I have to keep working, Charlie.”

“Hold your hands out for me, Jonny.”

“Why?”

“Just do it, please.”

He held both hands out flat, palms down, thumbs touching. They shook visibly.

She laughed lightly and held his shaking hands. "Jonny, look at me." When he did, she said, "You're going to lay down today, lay down in that big, comfy bed and get some sleep. Promise me."

"I promise I'll try."

"Thank you," she said, squeezed his hands again, pulled herself up and kissed his forehead. "Want me to make you some breakfast?"

"We still have bacon?"

"I think so," she said.

He nodded. She bounced on her toes happily and pivoted toward the bed; he stared at the pert round globes of her ass, just barely visible below her loose T-shirt.

Reza regarded her, laying on the bed, head on the pillow, both hands behind his head. The sheets were pulled back, and he was completely naked, legs apart, big, hairy genitals dangling down onto the bedding. "My little lovebirds," he said.

"You want some breakfast, too?" she asked him.

He said, "No. Just get Tate to get you something on the way in to work."

"I want to make Jonny breakfast. I can make you something, too."

"Fine," he said.

She put one knee up on the bed, rubbing her arm nervously. "Hey, Reza ...?" she asked him tentatively.

"What?"

"Have you ever thought ... you think maybe, you know, have you ever shaved yourself ... *down there*?" she said, pointing weakly between his legs.

"No," he scoffed, "I'm a man."

"Yeah. No, I know," she said. "Could you try?"

"I'm hairy," he said. "You know how dumb it would look if I shave just my dick?"

"It hurts my tongue. It scratches."

Reza shrugged.

Charlie touched the front of her panties. “Down here, too. Sometimes. When you’re really hard and you go deep—it scratches my ... *insides*.”

Reza stayed expressionless and held her gaze for a long while and Charlie fidgeted. Finally he said, “Charlie, come over here,” and he patted the space next to him on the bed.

She went to him reluctantly, climbing on the bed and walking on hands and knees to join him, her body language petulant. When she sat next to him he held her gaze for a long moment again until he had her full attention.

“What?” she asked him, looking uncomfortable.

“When Tate takes you to work today, I want you to give him a hand job.”

Charlie’s eyes went wide and her mouth fell open. Her cheeks went an instant fiery red. “*What ...?*” she whispered with disbelief. She tugged on a lock of her hair to hide her face from Jonny.

“Give Tate a hand job this morning.”

“*What ...?* No ... I *can’t*,” she said incredulously.

Jonny sighed, “Reza,” running an agitated hand through his hair, looking to complain though he knew it would be no use.

Reza ignored him, said to Charlie, “You like Tate, don’t you?”

“No,” she said sheepishly and hid her face further from Jonny.

“He likes you.”

“He does?”

Reza said, “He’s nice.”

“He is.”

Reza put a hand on her thin bare knee and she flinched a little. “He gives you a ride to work every morning. Why don’t you want to do something nice for him?”

Charlie's trembling eyes darted all over Reza's expression and he stared back, his stern face unwavering. He wasn't joking. Charlie continued to look for a break, a smile, some sort of faltering ... but the man stayed grim. Her shoulders began to sag, her posture slumping. She looked away. "Okay."

Reza's thick mustache twitched to one side and his eyes gleamed. "Okay? You'll jerk him off?"

Still looking away from him, Charlie nodded.

"Good. Take off your shirt."

With no further protest, Charlie took off her T-shirt, sitting next to Reza with her little tummy bunched up then holding the balled up shirt to cover her bare little breasts.

Reza shifted, turned to the side table and retrieved a small tube. "Use this," he said, handing it to Charlie.

"What is it?" she asked, looking it over.

"Lube, Charlie. Use it on Tate's cock. And I want you to collect his semen in your shirt."

Her head nodded forward, and she gaped. "*Why?*" she squeaked.

Reza said, "I want to know if you did it or not."

Charlie whined, "Can't you just ask him if I did it?"

Reza said, "Are you always going to be so difficult?"

"No."

"Just makes sure he comes in your T-shirt, okay?"

Charlie's face pinched to a trembling but defeated scowl. She nodded. "Okay."

"And Charlie?"

"What?"

"Do it at the library."

"My work?"

"In the car, parked at the library."

Charlie didn't answer but Jonny knew she would do as she was told. Her chin dipped down until it touched her chest then she scooted herself sideways till she was off the bed. With the things Reza had given her to jerk off Tate clutched to her chest she silently padded into the bathroom without looking at him and closed herself in there.

Jonny was numb, empty. He turned to Reza and Reza smiled. "You're sick," he said to him, and Reza's muscular shoulders shook with a quiet laugh.

CHAPTER TWO

WHEN TATE ARRIVED to pick up Charlie, she was still in the bathroom. As he would usually do, he came into the kitchen, looked down the pass-through to see if she was ready—she often wasn't—went to the cupboard, took down a mug and poured himself a coffee. Cream from the fridge (though Jonny couldn't see him he only heard the sounds), the tinkling of a spoon, the spoon being dropped in the stainless steel bottom of the sink. Then the big handsome guy was at the pass-through again. Sipping and watching him.

Tate asked him: “Reza already leave?”

Jonny had paused work, the worry about what had been assigned to his wife slowing down his thought processes, choking off the fire that had been roaring through his engine the last few days. “Yeah, left about ten minutes ago. Went to the gym.” It was no surprise, it was the man's usual routine. He would wake with Charlie, engage in some sort of oral or manual manipulation, harass Jonny in some manner, pour himself an espresso, put it in a to-go cup, grab the keys for his Porsche, remind Jonny the clock was ticking, then head off to the gym where he would work out then shower.

Tate took a sip of his espresso, nodded his head.

Now the apartment door opened again, and it startled Jonny. He turned to see Demetrius coming in, throwing his knapsack down on the floor next

to the fridge.

“Hey, dude, what’s happening?” Tate asked him. They engaged in a clasp of hands, a hug, and thumping each other’s backs, then some lighthearted ribbing. Jonny tried typing, but all he could concentrate on was the two guys in the kitchen. It sounded as though Demetrius needed a ride into the far side of the city today and arranged to meet Tate here. Jonny’s hands began to sweat. Would Charlie give both of them a hand job now? One was bad enough. But then again, if there was one, how bad was two, really? These were the horrible questions he prompted himself with these days. He rubbed his hands together, ran them up the inside of his forearms to try to dry them. The lock on the bathroom door clicked, and Charlie came out.

“Hey, there she is,” Tate said, pointing a finger at her through the pass-through with a smile on his face. Demetrius was coming down the stairs with the hands in the pockets of his khaki pants.

“What’s up with my man Jonny?” he said.

“Nothing,” Jonny said, unable to keep the sullen tone out of his voice.

“Must be something up, I hear you click-clacking.”

“Working,” he said.

Charlie had gone into the closet to put her things away, came out now and he saw her facing him in his periphery. He turned to face her. They both looked at each other with no expressions. Then Demetrius was there.

“How’s this shit coming?” Demetrius asked him, putting a hand on the back of his chair and looking over his shoulder at the screens.

“Can’t you tell?” Jonny said, being an asshole since all that was on his screen was a bunch of rambling numbers and letters that he was sure Demetrius could make no sense of.

Demetrius asked, “What’s all this going to be when it works?”

“My game.”

Now Tate came down the stairs to join them, walking to stand between Demetrius and Charlie. He smiled and nodded at Charlie, and she averted her gaze, looked down at her feet. She inched away, stepping slightly to the side and hugging her own arms. Tate frowned, looking at her with puzzlement.

Jonny clicked the button, and all his code became a brief working interplay in a separate console window on another monitor. He looked up and saw Demetrius watching. He said, “All that shit you saw?—see this guy? That’s Player. Player goes round this corner, sees what ...?”

Demetrius watched, his face brightening for a moment, saying, “Boo-yah, a dragon. For real?”

“But look what happens?” He WSADd, and arrowed left, arrowed right. “See that? Then the Dragon goes round ... Player goes like this ... Check that shit out.” Demetrius watched on the screen as Jonny’s fun and elaborate animation played out the destruction of the dragon. He smiled broadly.

Jonny watched the remainder of his animation playing out in the reflection of Demetrius’s dark brown eyes.

Demetrius said, “No shit, Jonny. That’s actually pretty fuckin’ cool.”

Tate was looking, too, but not the kind of guy that would care, checking his watch now and saying, “Charlie, don’t we have to get going?”

Charlie nodded, still unable to look at Tate, her hands forming squirming fists at her sides now.

Tate said, “Hey, Charlie, you okay?”

She whispered, “Yeah, why?”

“You’re shaking.”

She said, “I’m okay. I am. Let’s just go.”

Demetrius said to her, “Yeah, we gotta go, Tate’s taking me out to the gym. We oughtta skedaddle.”

Charlie said, “Okay.”

Tate asked her: “You got all your things?”

She nodded again. Jonny looked her over, bothered by the worry that had twisted her, looking at her trembling mouth, but then seeing a bright blue bulge of cotton in her purse. It reminded him of what she had to do today and his stomach flipped right over.

Demetrius put his arm around her and escorted her away, saying, “You see your man’s game?”

“Yeah,” she said. “It’s pretty amazing.”

“Didn’t know that boy had it in him,” Demetrius said.

Jonny swiveled his chair to watch them leave. Tate lead the way, Demetrius with his arm around his wife following close behind. Charlie looked over her shoulder before they mounted the steps to the kitchen.

“Goodbye, Jonny.”

“Bye, Charlie.”

She put one foot up on the first step, turned back. “See you tonight.”

“I can’t wait,” he told her, but his own hands had formed fists around the bulging noses of the arms of his chair. He watched her being led up and out of the apartment. Out with those two men. Down to the car and then being driven to work. What would happen? What would she do today? She’d been instructed to do something awful, and he knew she would do it. When she came home tonight, she would know a lot more about Tate than she did right now, and a sharp dagger of worry worked through him. Charlie might deny it but Jonny was sure she had the beginnings of a crush on that big handsome man.

JONNY USED rage to blast through his morning—burning his system out, using up that energy drink like it was nitrous through him, he blazed through code with nothing else on his mind. It had been the only way to get through that first hour. Half-an-hour after his wife left the apartment, it was almost one-hundred percent sure that she had jerked off Tate. She had given

another man a hand job. Done it where Jonny couldn't see, did it without him. That was the kind of thing that would drive him legitimately crazy, ruin his day, knock this recent work freight train off its tracks—and the derailment would be enormous, all his scattered cargo would ruin the city. So instead of thinking, he went on autopilot. But after a few hours, the highest fuel exhausted itself, the energy drink's effects going thin and soon his eyes grew heavy and his thoughts became distracted. It was almost noon. Almost lunchtime, though he knew he would work through without eating. But if it was lunchtime that meant it was done. Charlie had put her hands on yet another man's penis. Charlie had made another man come. His virginal wife was familiar with yet another man's sexual equipment. And just like he told her, he imagined that Tate would also be quite large. There was an arousal there, something about this that sparked a fiery lust low in his belly. He tried to stifle it, smother it with rational thoughts and jealous anger, but he couldn't admit the glowing warmth of its spark. Between his legs, his arousal grew evident. Then work became impossible.

"Fuck. Fuck, fuck, fuck ... fuck this shit," he said and shoved against his desk with his two palms on the edge and rolled his chair back six feet from his workstation. Then he collapsed on his knees, buried his face in his hands. It was all too much. He was running on fumes and he was going to die. His heart pounded in his chest; abused by caffeine and tortured with painful love by the things his wife did to save their home.

He stood, stretched.

Maybe he would eat something. Yeah, maybe that would help. He turned to head to the kitchen, saw the bed, collapsed on it instead. He promised Charlie he would rest today. But how could he rest with the thoughts that raced through his mind?

They were awful images. Awful dreadful things.

He climbed on his elbows and knees to the center of the bed then turned over on his back and stared at the ceiling. Demetrius was there with them.

When she offered Tate a hand job would Demetrius get one as well? Would she ask them both to go into the back seat and she would sit in the center and stroke them at the same time? Maybe there would be some kind of race, some sort of prize offered for the one who came last. Maybe the one who came last got to do it inside Charlie. Maybe whoever came first let the other man put it inside Charlie, finish there.

He dug his thumbs into his waistband and eased his track pants down. Maybe if he masturbated, he could chase some of these thoughts away. Maybe if he masturbated, he could get some sleep.

Hand on his cock, he found it slippery already. Just the idea of the unknown was driving him wild. The idea that Charlie had definitely engaged in something this morning but he wasn't quite sure what it was had provoked an excitement. He squeezed himself, more of his clear lubrication spewing from his tip. He stroked. Stroked and pictured Charlie doing the worst things. And the quicker his stroke the worse those images became. He slowed himself. There was something awful about the image of Tate in her vagina and Demetrius in her anus. Something terrible in the way he pictured his wife's face if she experienced that. He slowed his stroke, went slow, tried to imagine just Charlie and Tate now. Charlie's slender hand working over Tate's most definitely large and gnarly manhood. His wife watching, her eyes traveling up and down another man's penis, again much larger than her husband. He stroked slowly and luxuriously, his eyes rolling up in his head ...

CHAPTER THREE

JONNY WOKE to the sound of the apartment door opening and it made him jump. Not sure where he was, what was happening, he scrambled across the bed and got his feet on the floor. His pants were down and he ripped them up to cover himself. He'd fucking fallen asleep. What time was it?—if Charlie was home it had to be almost six.

Head swimming in sleepy cotton, he struggled to stand, but he swooned and his knees buckled—he had to throw his hands out on the bed to stop from falling. Sleep struggled to get a hold of him and he reeled with dizziness; closing his eyes made it worse. But when he found the strength, he got himself upright, saw that the person softly moving around in the kitchen was indeed Charlie, the back of her ginger head seen at the pass-through moving around at the kitchen counter. She moved quietly—had come in wordlessly—and now he wondered if something was wrong. Wondered if some of those dark thoughts he'd had before drifting off to sleep could have really occurred.

“Charlie?” he said up to the kitchen, taking a few shaky steps toward the stairs, hands out to the side should he fall from grogginess or pass out.

“Hi, Jonny,” she said from the kitchen, her voice sweet but tentative. Not mad at him, but it was a sign she might be troubled by something.

He checked his watch and saw it was four minutes after six. That was six fucking hours he'd lost today. Six wasted hours he couldn't get back, and frankly he didn't feel better after the sleep, he felt worse. He rubbed his eyes and rubbed his temples. There was a dull ache in the very cherry pit of his skull. Probably a tumor. His neck ached, his back raced with up-and-down low-voltage zaps as his body swayed from side to side. When he opened his eyes, he saw his beautiful young wife at the top of the stairs. She watched him speculatively, lips pulled thin, eyes narrowed. She wore a nice navy sweater and a plaid skirt that came to her knees; she clutched her purse against her stomach protectively.

"Hey," he said and forced a friendly smile for her.

"Are you okay?" she asked and came down one step.

"Do I look bad?" he joked and ran a hand through his clumping hair.

"No, Jonny," she said, coming down one more step. "You look like you're going to pass out."

"Oh," he said. "Yeah, I feel like I'm going to pass out."

"Jonny, I know how hard you're working—baby, I appreciate it so much," she said, and now she came to him and put her arms around him, holding her purse behind his back. "I love you for it, Jonny, but, please, for my sake, slow down a little."

His arms went around her narrow back and he nuzzled his chin into her curly mane, feeling the soft waves of her fragrant hair against his cheek.

"I did, Charlie. I took your advice. I fell asleep this afternoon and ... and now I feel worse."

"That's because you're not getting enough sleep, Jonny. Your body wants more that's why you don't feel good."

"I can't, Charlie. I hate this. I hate you ... with him."

"Me, too, Jonny, but I can take it. Handle it. You know what I mean."

"I know you can, baby. But I'm going to show you. Show Reza."

She pulled away, a big confident smile on her face. “You don’t have to tell me, mister. I’m the one that believes in you.”

Fingers digging into his throbbing eye sockets, he said, “You do. I know you do. That’s why I’ll never let you down.”

Her warm hand caressed his cheek, and he chuckled, eyes fluttering open. “Slow down, Jonny. That’s all. Take your time and do it right. Okay? I don’t want you to suffer while you do this. That’s not what it’s about. If it takes a little longer ...”

He couldn’t help groaning and her posture slumped.

“Jonny, it’s not like that.”

“I know,” he whined. But wasn’t it? *Take more than six months, Jonny. I’ll be our landlord’s sex slave for longer, don’t worry, I can take it.* Take it? Take it deep, Charlie? But he couldn’t say a fucking thing. Truth was he *couldn’t* finish in six months. He’d *need* more time. Wasn’t that kind then that she offered, asshole? He’d like to think it was, hated to think some secret part of her liked this arrangement enough she wanted it to last longer.

“You’re groggy?” she said, looking in his eyes for confirmation.

He nodded.

That big smile happy smile returned, and she said, “You can’t go straight back to work. You need to wake up ...?”

“Maybe,” he said, smiling too, loving to see her getting bubbly with her Charlie energy.

She said, “Order a pizza. Okay? We’ll get a pizza, a meat lover’s, and fried pickles, and we’ll sit on the couch and you’ll watch one episode of Twilight Zone with me ...”

“Charlie,” he chastised, but he was being drawn to the picture she painted.

“One episode, Jonny. One episode.”

“Yes,” he surrendered happily.

“Oh my God—yes, Jonny?”

“Yes,” he said. “I want to.”

“I can’t believe it,” she giggled, and seeing her like this broke his heart and at the same time affirmed why he was doing this. “Jonny, order us dinner. Get all those things I said, get dessert, too. I’m so happy, Jonny,” she said, and she reached up and kissed his chin, clutching her purse between them. “Order from Angelo’s, okay? I’m going to get cleaned up, get my PJs.”

“Okay,” he said, fighting with the twisting in his stomach. Angelo’s was where Reza liked, he and Charlie had been Domino’s customers.

Charlie crossed between the bed and his workstation, went to the closet, gave him a sheepish smile, grabbed her PJs and trotted into the bathroom where she closed herself in. He retrieved his phone from the desk and drew up a phone book to find Angelo’s number. Domino’s app right there on the screen, but now Charlie was an Angelo’s girl. When he called, they put him on hold.

He ended up in the closet with his phone pinched to his ear by his shoulder. Charlie’s purse, an expensive one, a Fendi gifted by Reza, sat on a shelf at chest height. The sides were ballooned out as if stuffed for showroom display but Charlie was just not the kind of girl who packed her purse full of stuff. Not that kind of girl at all. What did Charlie carry?—maybe a Chapstick for when it was windy, her pocketbook, phone, small pack of tissue, a hair clip probably, some gum, she liked wintergreen, and certain times of the month, maybe a sanitary pad. He knew what puffed the bag out, and he took it down and tossed it on the bed.

“Angelo’s.” An abrupt Italian voice in his ear over top of banging and clanging kitchen noises.

“Hey. Delivery, meat lover’s, extra-large, you got fried pickles?”

“Fried pickles? Yeah, how many you want?”

He drew the gold zipper on the purse and its mouth opened on its own, pushed out by the stuffed contents within. “How they come?”

“Half dozen, dozen, what you want?”

“A dozen,” he said. Blossoming from the zippered grin of the Fendi bag was bunched royal blue cotton. “You guys do brownies?”

“No.”

“Tiramisu?”

“Yeah, you want that?”

“Sure,” he said, poking at the T-shirt his wife had hidden inside her purse. He added Cokes to the order, and the guy repeated it all back and he affirmed it but hadn’t heard a thing, really. Told the guy he’d pay cash, guy said half an hour, he said okay and hung up. Phone tossed on the bed, he studied the T-shirt wadded in his wife’s purse and prepared the nerve.

When he was ready he pulled it out. It stayed wadded. When he tugged at its rounded shape, it made stiff crinkling noises and resisted his pull.

“You order pizza?” Charlie asked coming out of the bathroom and trying to tie her hair back in a ponytail. She saw him with the evidence and she said, “What are you doing?”

“WHAT DOES it look like I’m doing?”

“Going through my purse, Jonny,” she said with a little menace and she came to stand beside him. He tugged at the stiff fabric again and she stopped him. “Don’t do that, don’t, please.” She reached to take the shirt from him but he held it out where she couldn’t get it. “Don’t” she said again, looking in his eyes, her jaw set firm. She wasn’t messing around.

He still held it away, but they locked their gaze and he felt himself softening. What she did with Tate was inevitable. What Reza asked would be done. Within reason. They could always say no but then there would be consequences. “Why not?” he said.

Up on the bed on her knees, she gripped his arm and walked her fingers to his wrist and then took the balled up shirt from him and held it to her

chest. She didn't answer him.

"Why not, Charlie?" he asked again. "I know why it's stiff."

"Keep it together so I can show Reza. Don't break it all apart," she said without looking at him, her vacant stare aimed inside her dark closet. She sat down now and put her feet on the floor.

His heart rate picked up, and now he was mad. "So it's full of Tate's semen?"

She looked up to him, puzzled. "You just said you know why it's stiff."

"You jerked him off?"

She looked down and away again, into the closet.

They stayed like that for near a minute, her with a dirtied shirt against her chest, staring at nothing, him standing over her, listening to his heavy breathing. He sat down next to her, almost touching her and they looked at nothing together.

He said, "You did it? What Reza asked?"

In his periphery, she nodded her head.

"Why do you want to hide it from me?"

"I don't want you to think of me doing that."

He nodded now. "If you don't tell me, it's like you're keeping a secret. We can't have secrets."

"We can't," she agreed.

They were quiet for a while again while Jonny came to grips with the reluctant excitement that built inside him picturing his wife giving a stranger a hand job in broad daylight. It would have been sunny and bright this morning, every detail of what she held in her hand in bright technicolor. Did she watch herself do it? Did she watch it come out of him and squirt into her shirt? He hated that she'd done it, hated that he was getting hard thinking about it, too. "You did it like Reza asked?"

"Yeah," she sighed.

"Did you do Demetrius, too?"

“Demetrius ...? No,” she said, looking at him sideways. “We dropped him off at the gym. It’s on the way to the library.”

“Hey, Charlie?—would you look at me ...” he asked turning now to face her, and she met his eyes. “All you did was use your hand?”

Her eyes stayed wide and expressive, but her brow lowered a little. “Of course, Jonny. I just did what Reza told me.”

After studying her for a moment, he said, “Okay. Can you tell me what happened?”

“Why do you want to hear that, Jonny?”

“Why do you want to leave me out of it?”

Now her shoulders slumped, and she cocked her head, looking at the ceiling. “What do you want to hear?”

“Everything,” he said.

Her gaze returned to meet his, and he could see her hand creeping across to his lap and it put a flutter in his stomach. She rested her balled up hand in the crease of his hip. The front of his sweat pants were already tented out, the head of his cock making a rounded impression against the fleecy fabric as it pointed straight up between his legs.

She asked, “When’s dinner coming?”

“We have twenty-five minutes. Tell me what you did.”

“That’s how you want to do it?”

“What do you mean?”

“Reza will be home probably in a couple hours. You want to do it fast before the pizza guy gets here?”

“Just tell me, Charlie.”

“You’re hard,” she said, her eyes looking down at the way he poked his pants up. Her hand moved from his hip to open and touch the tip of his erection with the pads of her fingers.

“I know,” he said. “Tell me what you did. Please.”

After a long contemplative pause, she huffed, then said, “We didn’t stop for breakfast this morning because I ate here. We went out east first and dropped Demetrius off at the gym.”

“And Demetrius didn’t try anything with you?”

“No,” she said. “Then Tate drove me up to the library, and he parked.”

“Were you nervous?”

“Of course,” she said with some distress and ran her hands through her hair.

“You’ve never done anything with him before?”

“No, Jonny. I would tell you.”

“You like him?”

“What do you mean?”

“You like Tate?”

She shrugged her shoulders and looked away. “He’s nice. He’s not like the others.”

“Not like Reza.”

“No, not like Reza at all.”

He smiled a little and let her see it then reached over and rested his hand over the curve of her upper thigh. She’d changed into soft, cotton pajama pants, and a baggy T-shirt. “So did you just reach over and grab him?”

She shook her head no. “I just told him. Told him Reza wanted me to do ... *that*.”

“What did he say?” His hand slipped higher, working underneath her shirt and finding the warm skin of her flat tummy.

“He didn’t want me to.”

“He didn’t?”

Head shaking no again, she said, “He told me he didn’t want that.”

“Really?”

Now a nod. “Then I felt like he thought I was dirty or something. Like he didn’t have any respect for me.” Her face got sad.

“Oh, Charlie,” he said, drumming his fingers on her navel to cheer her up.

“I got upset.”

“You did?”

Nodding again. “Yeah. Then *he* felt bad. Which was nice. I told him to just let me do it.”

CHAPTER FOUR

JONNY LET his hand slip lower, dipping the blade underneath the bunched up drawstring waist, and Charlie sucked her stomach in, let her legs part slightly. “So then what?”

“I told him I had to make him come into my T-shirt and I took it out of my purse to show him. So he just stared at me and I was going to get upset again. But he takes the shirt and tells me to go to into the library. I tell him again what Reza wants and he, like, smiles, and says when he picks me up after work it’ll be ready.”

“What does that mean?”

She was smiling, too, remembering the kind gesture. “He would do it himself. Masturbate into my T-shirt.”

“Oh,” Jonny said, the story taking an unexpected turn, his hand paused just above her hot, bare mound.

“But I told him I better do it.”

“You did?” he said in a strangely bright tone. Somehow aroused that she had a way out but talked Tate into letting her give him a hand job. The tips of his fingers tingled, and that arousal was dampened by a sudden rising fear he didn’t like. “Why?”

“I don’t know. I trust Tate, but I worried it was a trap or a test. Or there was some other way Reza could tell that I didn’t know about. Like he had

cameras in Tate's car, or microphones."

"Yeah," he sighed, his hips squirming, aching for Charlie to touch his erection. Her rationale made sense, and it calmed him, suppressed the fear and allowed the arousal to swell large again. "So you did do it?"

"Uh-huh," she said, nodding her head and still avoiding his eyes. "Are you okay?"

"I am," he said. "All you've done, that's pretty tame. And I know why you do it. Thank you for doing it."

She smiled a little and her eyes wandered up to meet his. "It's okay," she said.

Eyes still on hers he let his hand crest her mound and he touched her little slit with his first two fingers, gathered up her folds and found them already wet. "Tell me more."

Her eyes narrowed as he played with her pussy, and her head slowly drifted back, lips parting.

"Charlie?" He prompted her as her pussy made slick sounds under his fingers.

"He was kind of nervous," she whispered, eyes closed as if to help her better picture it.

"Was he? Tell me."

"We were parked right out front of the library. Not even in a parking spot, right up at the curb in the roundabout. At the bottom of the stairs. People were coming and going but no one was really paying attention."

The tips of his fingers used her flood of lubrication to run lines up and down the direction of her folds, teasing at her opening, pushing inside just the slightest then retreating.

"We got close together in his car, close as we could get, and he unzipped his pants. I made sure no one was looking, and I reached over and put my hand inside his fly." Now she leaned her shoulder on him and her hand went under his shirt and then down the front of his sweatpants.

“Jonny, you’re so hard.” she said as she gave him a gentle squeeze. He flexed his stomach and encouraged a steady stream of pre-come.

“Was he hard?”

“Not when I put my hand in his pants. I think he was nervous because it was light outside, and people kept walking by.”

“Where you nervous?”

“Of course.”

“Were you ... turned on?”

“*What?* No, Jonny,” she said quietly, but he wasn’t convinced that was the truth. Her freckled cheeks went rosy. She changed the subject by running her hand up and down his shaft. It worked; she had him groaning and flinching in seconds.

He gasped, “Tell me ...”

“What?” she whispered. “That he’s got a big penis? He does, Jonny. I played with it inside his pants while we were both looking out the windows to see if we were noticed.”

“Did you like it?”

“His penis? Uh-humm,” she gasped, and now her hips rocked against the motion of his hand. She’d gotten wetter.

“Is he as big as Reza?”

“Gosh, I don’t know. He’s really big. I didn’t see it until he was a little hard and then I got out the lube Reza gave me. His thing lay on his pant leg. And Jonny ...?”

“What?” He groaned in erotic agony, hearing her words, feeling her hand on his cock, but the most troubling was her own body’s reaction, the wet smacking noises his fingers that produced.

“Tate’s isn’t ugly. I like the way his looks.”

“You liked it?” he gasped now and hunched over hearing that terrible admission. Her hand stroked him smoothly, and he bubbled more excitement that made her grip like warm liquid.

“Oh Jonny, does that turn you on?”

It did, but he didn't know what to say. He didn't like how it made him feel so he said, “No.”

She moaned and squeezed his cock tighter, between her legs her canal sucked tightly on two of his fingers.

“Tate has a big cock, Jonny, but I like it. It's smooth, and clean, and it doesn't have all that extra skin.”

“He's circumcised?”

“He is. Like you.”

“You don't like foreskin?”

“I don't know, Jonny. I like Tate's penis,” she moaned, trailing off, lifting her knees higher by pushing off the floor with her toes, wanting him to put his fingers deeper.

“I want to fuck you so bad, Charlie,” he said watching her face as she enjoyed the pleasure he gave her with his hand.

“We can't, Jonny,” she gasped. “We can't.”

“Let me get a condom,” he said.

“Make me come first, Jonny,” she said, gripping his cock with one hand and now the other one clutching at his arm to prevent him trying to leave.

The look on her face drove him wild, and he got up, pushing her to lay back on the bed with two of his fingers thrusting in and out of her. She drew up her knees and planted both feet on the bed while he got over top of her.

“How long did it take?” he growled near her ear.

She moaned, eyes closed, head rocking. “It was clumsy at first because he's big and floppy but once it was hard, God, I got him to come pretty quick.”

His stomach tightened harder, like cinching a wet not. “You did it good?”

“I did. I made him come.” Her hand on him stroked faster now, but absently. He wondered how different his felt from Tate to her. Wondered if

she felt disappointed with his size though it had never been an issue before.

“Did you grab his balls?” he asked, hoping she would grab his now. She did. One hand stroking him, the other coming up to grip his dangling testicles. Fingers went to three that he thrust into her, his Charlie needing more stretch these days.

“No. I was shy.”

“You were shy?”

“I, mm, wanted to make him come, do it well, but not be too eager.”

“You’re such a good girl,” he sighed, his hips pumping his cock eagerly through her slippery grip.

“I am,” she whimpered then frowned. “Jonny, please ... make me come.” Her pussy clamped on him and she dug her heels down on either side of his knees, pumping hard against his hand.

His face went over hers and he braced himself, digging his knees into the mattress, leaning his weight forward on one elbow while his arm tensed hard and he fucked her with three bunched fingers. His penis was forgotten, and he was okay with that. She held it in one hand, her grip loose, the other gently cupped his testicles. Charlie writhed underneath him, her face twisted up and scrunched, her eyes tightened to thin lines with pale lashes fluttering from where they were squeezed in the fold of her lids. Her breath was held and as he fucked her harder and harder, she took on a rosy cast and the veins stood out on her long neck.

“That’s it, Charlie,” he whispered, “Take his big cock, take that big beautiful cock ...”

She grunted and blurted air out her nose, turned her face from him, drew in a short desperate gasp of air.

“Feel it fucking you, Charlie? Feel Tate’s big cock? Does it feel good?”

Face still scrunched up, she turned so he could see her face. She nodded slightly.

“That’s it, Charlie, Tate loves your tight little pussy, his big perfect cock never felt such a perfect pussy ...”

It was what she needed and now she bucked underneath him, hips thrusting up to pin his fingers deep inside her and he fed them deep into her hungry hole. She gushed on him, her juices had coated his hand and he could feel some of her wet warmth even up his forearm. Her pussy crackled wetly around his hand as she came. Her back arched, and she blurted air again, the expulsion becoming a long, draggy moan before a hoarse intake of air. His penis had been abandoned at some point and now he watched her two long hands stroke over her own mound, her fingers caressing her folds where they stretched around his finger’s intrusion.

AS SHE CAME down from her orgasmic high, she slowly turned to her side and rolled away to hide herself from him. He let her go, let his hand come free from her sweatpants as they closed with a tight smack against her belly.

“What’s wrong?” he asked her.

After groaning again, she covered her face with her hands, spoke through them. “I can’t believe I said those things.”

“Sit up,” he said.

She did, still hiding from him and pushing her face into his collar and hugging him. His arms went around her.

“Charlie, it’s okay. I’m not upset.”

“I know, but I love you. I shouldn’t ever say those things.”

“Is it true?”

After a brief hesitation: “No.”

“It’s okay if it’s true, Charlie. I can take it. You didn’t like Tate’s penis?”

“Jonny, don’t,” she whispered.

“I think you did, Charlie, and I still love you,” he told her while he stroked her back with the inside of his wrist, his wet hand bent away. “What hurts is not knowing the truth.”

She squeezed him tighter. “Sit back for me,” she said.

Their embrace came apart, and they looked in each other’s eyes and he saw warmth there in hers, and love for him. He smiled. Both her hands caressed his thighs, rubbing up and down the cotton of his sweatpants.

Now she said, “Take your little dick out for me.”

His body jumped with sudden surprise, and that deep sexual part of him, low in his belly, squashed suddenly as if she’d kicked him there, its jelly center bursting sweet strawberry goo up behind his eyes.

Charlie’s face went wide with shock and disbelief and she clapped both hands over her mouth and nose, her eyes bugging out at him. “I can’t believe I said that,” she whispered through her hands.

He stared at her dumbly, his mouth drying out, his heartbeat squishing loudly in his ears.

“Is that okay?” she asked him, parting her hands so he could see her soft pink lips move. “I thought you might like that.”

He nodded, swallowed, and licked his lips.

“Well, mister,” she said with unconvincing bossiness, “show me that tiny little pecker.”

He swallowed again, his features frozen and his hands made it to his waistband, pulled his pants away to show her what he had.

“It really is little,” she said to herself, and that was somehow, horribly and also excitingly, convincing. “It’s not even hard, Jonny,” she said, eyes darting up to his.

“It’s not?” he said, looking to see if she was mistaken. His throbbing erection had dwindled; it stuck out of his nest of scraggly pubic hairs at unimpressive half-mast.

“Did you come?” she asked him and touched around the head of his penis with the tip of her forefinger. He was slick with excitement but he had not come.

“No,” he said.

“You didn’t?” she said with a troubled voice.

“I’ll get hard again, Charlie, don’t worry.”

“Do you not like me saying dirty things? About your size?” Her eyes met his, and he saw honest concern there.

“I like it,” he said, and he did. “I just ... I’m so aroused, like my heart is racing, and I can’t believe ... I’m not hard.”

Now she made a mean face at him and said, “Imagine if you had a little dick *and* you couldn’t get hard.”

He groaned with true excitement. “Use your hand, Charlie, please, help me.” He pushed his sweatpants down his thighs, past his knees and scooted closer.

“Want me to use my mouth?” she asked him.

“Maybe. Hand now, talk dirty, okay?” he said with mounting urgency, he’d begun to ache just below his balls.

“Okay, Jonny,” she whispered, and she took up his half-hard member between thumb and forefinger and tried to jerk it a little.

It took a moment to build the nerve, but he asked her: “Do you think it’s small?”

Her eyes moved up from watching her fingers stroke him, and she twisted her mouth to the side. “It’s smaller than the other guys I’ve been with.”

“Who’ve you been with Charlie?” he asked her.

“Just you, Jonny. Just you for real. But you know ... Reza, I used my mouth on Demetrius, and my hand ... my hand on Tate.”

“That’s it?”

“Yes, Jonny,” she said pleadingly.

“And I’m the smallest?”

She sighed with slight exasperation. “You know you’re the smallest, Jonny.”

“And that’s okay with you?”

She huffed, like his question was dumb, watching her fingers still stroking his uncooperative penis. “Of course, Jonny,” she said with a smile.

“You don’t like Reza’s size?”

“I don’t know.”

“He makes you come with it. You don’t even like him, and he makes you come.”

“I can’t help that, Jonny, I told you I was sorry, I—”

“It’s okay, Charlie.”

She made a pained face, slowed her stroke. “It goes really deep, and he’s ... thick ... it gets some spot inside me and after a while I just can’t help it.”

“I can’t reach that spot?”

She shook her head no, but then smiled, her eyes downturned to his penis. She whispered, “Hey, you’re getting hard now.”

“Hurry, Charlie, faster, faster, I want to come so bad ...”

“Okay, Okay,” she laughed and leaned forward, put one hand on his pubic pad, the other trying to grip his dick and stroke it.

His penis hardened, and it felt glorious. “Yes, Charlie, that’s it, come on,” he said. “Tell me you liked Tate’s.”

She shook her head no, her brow lowered and her mouth going thin. Her hand picked up speed and took on wet sounds as he streamed pre-cum now.

“Tell me, Charlie ...”

“I don’t want to say that, Jonny ...” She ducked her head down and stroked even faster, shaking the bed with her rapid movements. “Come, Jonny, come ...”

There was a loud knock at the door, the pizza guy coming up without buzzing, someone letting him in at the front door.

“Shit,” he hissed.

“You close?” she asked, her eyes on his, her face gone red with effort, the veins standing out in her forearms.

“Hurry, Charlie, hurry,” he urged, hoping she would just blurt out the most perfect awful thing to say but even he didn’t know what it was.

The knock came again, louder this time.

“Get off, Jonny, just get off already,” she said with frustration.

“I can’t ... I can’t,” he said, and he put his hand down to hold her wrist, stop her stroke.

She gave him a mean face again, and this time it seemed more genuine. She thumped her little fist onto the mattress. “It’s those energy drinks, Jonny! You’re not sleeping, you’re not taking care of yourself.” Her lips trembled, and he saw her eyes take a pinkish hue.

“I’m sorry,” Charlie, he whispered.

But she shook her head and got off the bed. Another knock, and this time she shouted, “I’m coming,” her voice tinged with stress. Her back to him, she straightened her clothes, smoothed her hair, smelled her hands and checked for wetness at the front of her pants. She left him there, went up to the kitchen and answered the door while he pulled his pants back up. His cock burned like it had almost caught fire.

ON HIS KNEES STILL, he sat on the bed and waited, listening to Charlie answer the door, talk to some cocky sounding guy who she invited into the kitchen. Guy tried flirting with her but she sounded sombre. He brought the food right into the kitchen for her and Jonny could see the guy through the kitchen pass-through but he didn’t look down and see Jonny on the bed

watching him. Charlie paid him from cash that Reza always kept for her in one of the drawers and then the guy left.

“Okay, Jonny. Dinner’s here,” she said from the kitchen, her voice soft and weak.

He got off the bed and climbed the steps to the kitchen, walking into a wall of cologne left over from the delivery guy. The pizza box and a bag of food were arranged on the kitchen table and Charlie stood over them with her back to him, both hands resting on the table and her head hanging down. It made him stop in his tracks and he wanted to comfort her but was afraid she might be mad at him for some reason.

Now she said, “I’m sorry I snapped at you, Jonny.”

“It’s okay,” he said.

They stood a moment, neither of them talking, and he just watched her back move with her breathing. When he was convinced she *wasn’t* angry with him he went to her and put his arms around her. She slumped against him, relieved seemingly to feel his touch. Her nails ran on his forearm.

“It just doesn’t feel good when you can’t give pleasure to someone you love.”

“What?” he said incredulously. “You give me pleasure, Charlie. You do. I’m sorry I couldn’t come. I don’t know what happened there ...”

Charlie’s hand came up to rub at her own forehead, dig into a temple.

“Charlie ...?” he said and turned her around to face him.

She looked up in his eyes and said, “You don’t think I’m ... dirty or something do you?”

“What on earth ...? What do you mean?”

“Are you turned off because I sleep with Reza, or I do some other things with other guys?”

The words he had were frozen with disbelief, and he made a funny airy noise instead, hugging her tighter as he did. “How could you think that, Charlie?” he sighed.

“How could I not?”

“Gosh, no. I love you so much, and there’s no way I think you’re dirty or that I’m turned off by you. Don’t ever say that.”

“You could barely get hard. You couldn’t come ...”

He swayed with her now, his heart bursting with affection for her and her sweetness, how she could be concerned for him during all this. “It’s the caffeine drinks and the bad living, baby. You were right. All those dirty things you were saying were perfect Charlie, I wanted to hear them. It didn’t happen because of things I do, not the things you do.”

She nodded her chin against his chest and looked up at him, her eyes a little wet. “I know sometimes you get hard when you watch Reza do stuff to me and that’s okay. But this is an awful lot sometimes and I worry that you won’t love me when we get through it. You’ll get rich and successful and run off with some girl who isn’t ... *bad*.”

He showed her a stern and confident face. “I hate other girls. You’re the only one for me ever.”

“You mean it?”

“Frankly, I’m insulted that you question my love,” he said, smiling, hoping to brighten her up.

She said, “Thanks, Jonny. I’d say we have to call this off if it wasn’t too late already.”

“It’s too late,” he agreed and embraced her again.

“Sometimes it’s not so bad,” she said.

“What do you mean?”

“Food and stuff. And I know you’re going to get us out of it.”

“What if it takes me longer than six months?”

“Jonny, we’re a team. Keep me in the loop, tell me what’s going on and we can work this out. We’re husband and wife.”

He licked his lips and looked in her eyes. “I need help. I *can* do it all on my own but not in time—I can’t afford to hire someone and no one will

work for me on promise of back end. Not any more.”

“Not any more,” she agreed.

“It’ll take me six months, no, more like eight to have a beta, and the beta won’t be really functional. That’s me working a-hundred-twenty hour weeks.”

The look she gave him wasn’t disappointment, wasn’t fear or worry, it was something calm and assuring, maybe calculating. “Okay, Jonny. Okay.” Her eyes scrolled up and to the right. With a step back she began to smile and nod. “You know what? We’ll figure it out. Don’t worry, we’ll figure something out. I don’t know what it is, baby, but I *know* we’ll figure it out.”

Now he smiled too.

“Does it feel better to tell the truth?” she asked him.

“It does.”

“You promised me something.”

“I did?”

“You were going to eat a pizza with me and we would watch TV together,” she said, drumming her fingers on the top of the Angelo’s pizza box. She looked so adorable.

“Absolutely, Charlie,” he said. And with a wink, added, “Maybe later we can try again.”

CHAPTER FIVE

THEY DIDN'T TRY AGAIN LATER, but he had the best night off with her in the longest time. They drank Cokes, ate pizza and fried pickles, had some tiramisu that was incredible. They watched an episode of *The Twilight Zone* and by the end of it he was drifting off, laying his head in Charlie's lap while she played with his hair. The episode ended, and he pretended to sleep. Charlie let him, skipping to the next episode instead of waking him like he'd asked her. And he let her get away with that too, watching with narrowed eyes and smiling, nuzzling himself into her.

They must have fallen asleep together because he awoke with the sound of a booming voice and shrill female laughter in the hallway outside the apartment. He sat up, looked around. Charlie was flat on the couch, sleeping with her mouth open and her hands balled up in the sleeves of her sweatshirt. He'd been wedged between her and the back of the couch, his head on her stomach. The TV was still on, but the screen was blank.

The voices in the hall drew nearer, coming down the hall from the elevators. Two people having fun, maybe a little too much drink in them. The deep voice was most assuredly Reza, no one else down this end of the hall like him, as boisterous as him, and with little regard to tenants who might be trying to sleep ... he checked his watch ...

Shit, ten-thirty. This whole day had been wasted. He'd worked around the clock since yesterday, till dawn this morning, a little more after breakfast ... and that was it. Then he'd been sleeping, fantasizing, fucking, or trying to fuck Charlie, eating, watching TV and now more sleeping. But his wonderful Charlie's words today had mended his stitching. He'd been stretching himself so far he was ready to tear.

Two people banged up against the door to the apartment and it set the girl laughing in histrionics, cooing and reciting Reza's name. Great, now he was bringing people home with him.

A key jiggled in the door, then it burst open and Reza and some woman tumbled into the kitchen. Charlie's eyes fluttered, and she jumped up, looking wildly at Jonny then spinning behind to look up in the kitchen. She saw them as well, Reza wearing a suit and pressing this woman up against their fridge much like he'd done with her coming home from their date a while back. She looked at Jonny fearfully, then away at the television, wiping the drool from her mouth with the sleeve of her shirt, smoothing back her hair.

"Who's that?" she whispered to him.

"Beats me," he said.

Charlie rubbed her face now, her hands still balled up in the sleeves of her sweatshirt and twisting knuckles into the hollow cups of her eyes. She blinked then, looked at him, said, "What's she doing here?"

He shrugged. What *was* she doing here? How would *he* know?

They both looked again and they could see the woman now. Short, Latina, short limbed but shapely—thick legs and a big bottom, tiny waist, wearing a tight, hot pink dress that hugged all her curves and pushed up her perky but meager bosom. Her skin was olive, almost a dark tan, her hair a lustrous black, tumbling down and hiding her face from them. Multiple tattoos scurried up one leg, starting at the calf and disappearing up the skirt. One whole arm was also drawn in ink in multiple colors and black lines that

they couldn't make out from where they sat. She had heavy, clunky jewelry, big earrings that shone from behind her tangled locks.

They saw her face now over Reza's shoulder. Up on her toes—and though she was short she wore high-heel platforms,—letting her peek around Reza's shoulder. She had a beautiful face, made up heavily with black drawn eyebrows and eyeliner, and bright red lipstick. She brightened seeing them, and eyes still on them she said to Reza, “That's her, right?”

Reza turned, and the two people stood side-by-side with their backs against the fridge. Reza's eyes were narrowing, hazy, and he looked at both of them and smiled. “That's her,” he said in a low gravelly voice.

“Hi,” Charlie said in a friendly and soft voice, even lifting a hand to gently wave.

“Hey,” Jonny said.

“Please to meet you,” the woman sang, an accent detectable, maybe Puerto Rican.

Reza gestured with his hand for her to go down the steps ahead of him and she did with her clutch held to her waist and trotting down the steps in her very high heels with surprising skill. She came to stand at the side of the coffee table and held out a well-manicured hand showing bright red nails with diamonds on them.

Reza said, “This is Genesis.”

Charlie shook Genesis's hand, said, “Nice to meet you, too,” having to clear her throat so she was audible.

Genesis held Charlie's grip, her black eyes watching her and her head moving from side to side. After a moment, she said, “And your name?”

“Oh ... Charlie. Sorry, I'm Charlie.” Then looking to him, she put her hand on his knee and said, “This is my husband, Jonny.”

Jonny stood up, trying to look calm but getting a bad feeling about their houseguest. He shook her hand as well and said it was nice to meet her.

Formalities over with, the woman turned around now and took in their apartment, her face poised in a held back laugh. “You told me it was small,” she said. “I hate to see you here.” With her eyes lowered down to Charlie now she said to Reza, “She must be really something.”

“She is something,” he said ominously. He stood and looked at Charlie with both his hands in the pockets of his suit pants.

Charlie reached for Jonny’s hand and he took hers, weaving his fingers through and clasping together.

“You want some wine?” Reza said to Charlie.

She nodded. Jonny squeezed her hand gently to show her support. Charlie wanted wine because she wanted to dull what she was predicting would happen. The same thing he was predicting what would happen.

With a thumb and finger stroking at the points of his mustache, Reza looked at Jonny and said, “Jonny, go grab us some wine, would you?”

It wasn’t a question, and Jonny just didn’t have the heart right now to get into it with Reza. The man had an audience of two women with him and that would put him, he imagined, in quite an ambitious mood. The last thing he needed was to be belittled right now after he’d seemed to claw back something with Charlie today. So he gave Charlie’s hand a squeeze, let it go, patted her on the knee, kissed her shoulder, got up walked around behind Reza and Genesis and went into the kitchen.

HE GOT out four glasses from the cupboard, found a bottle of red then opened it with a walnut-handled corkscrew. He gathered the glasses up, putting his fingers between the stems and with the bottle in his other hand went down to the family room. He found the three of them with a bong on the table and the room hazy with smoke. Charlie looked up at him, her face pinched, her expression sheepish. Caught doing something she thought she shouldn’t. She looked away and exhaled with a great cough. Coughed some

more then into her balled up fist and covered her face with her hair. He continued down around behind Genesis and Reza, put the glasses on the table. Reza saw that there were four there and said, “Oh, Jonny, you’re going to join us?”

He couldn’t help it. “I’m not welcome in my own home?”

Reza laughed, said, “Pour yourself a glass, Jonny. You can join us.”

Still couldn’t help it. “Oh gee, thanks.”

Reza’s eyes stayed on him, a smirk there but his gaze baleful.

Jonny took up the bottle, poured into each of the four glasses. Charlie watched him with a meek smile, her eyes pink and hazy. She took up her glass of wine but before she could step sip it, Reza stopped her.

“Hold on, Charlie. How about we drink to something?”

Genesis said, “Ooh, I like that. What we drinking to?” Her earrings made soft metallic singing noises as she spoke and shook her head.

“To Charlie, of course,” Jonny beat him to the punch. It was likely that Reza had intended something disgusting. And though his preemptive toast wouldn’t prevent it, he hoped it might deflate anything he might say.

Reza rolled his eyes, a superior smirk on his face, then, gaze back on Jonny, said, “And the things we do for her.” He tilted the glass back and finished the wine.

“To Charlie,” Genesis laughed, then drank back as well.

He looked to his wife, and she gave him another weak smile, then closed her eyes and tipped her glass back, both hands cradling the goblet, the stem extending between. She finished hers as well. Jonny took a sip.

In a soft and timid voice, Charlie said, “Did you want to see the shirt?”

Reza said, “What shirt?”

“You know—from this morning ...” She made a jerking off gesture with her fist but tried to hide it so Jonny wouldn’t see.

Reza said, “What are you talking about, Charlie?”

Voice tight, she whined, “What you asked me to do this morning.”

Reza regarded her with a frown then it came to him. “Oh, right. You did it?”

Charlie nodded. “Do you want to see?”

“No,” he said, leaning forward and pouring another glass of wine for the three of them. “You did it?”

“I did.”

“Good.”

“I thought you wanted me to prove it.”

“I don’t think you’d lie,” he said, studying her with a narrowed gaze.

“What are we talking about?” Genesis said, pouting.

Reza turned to her and said, “I asked Charlie to jerk Tate off this morning.”

Genesis grinned and looked to Charlie. “Oh, he’s handsome, isn’t he?” She practically writhed in her chair.

Charlie shrugged. Then Genesis and Reza stared at her for a long, uncomfortable moment. Genesis continued to squirm in the chair, flexing her hips like she was rubbing her sex against the cushioned seat, licking her lips like she would soon consume Charlie. She crossed one muscular leg over the other and leaned close to Reza. Jonny got a clear display that Genesis didn’t wear underwear. He could see her hairy sex, her twisted brown labia pierced with something bright, maybe another diamond. He looked away.

Genesis whispered in Reza’s ear, her sly eyes regarding Charlie while she did. Reza leaned close to listen and whatever he was told made him smile. When he sat straight again, he said, “Charlie ...?”

“Yes,” she said in a soft whisper.

“Lift up your shirt, please.”

“Lift up my shirt?” she said in a whine, her brow pinched up in the middle.

“I wanna see your belly,” Genesis said and clamped the hard glossy nail of her pinky between her brilliant white teeth. One of them was gold.

Mouth twisted to the side, Charlie looked at Jonny sheepishly first, then back to them, bunched up the waist of her sweatshirt and T-shirt and slowly scrolled them up. As she did, he saw her tummy fluttering, her skin go to gooseflesh despite how warm the apartment was. She sucked her stomach in.

“Ooh, I love her,” Genesis said with sleepy eyes. Reza nudged her arm, and she smiled, slunk off the chair and got on her hands and knees walked over to Charlie like a sexy cat.

“What’s she going to do?” Charlie whimpered.

“I just love tummies,” Genesis said and got her hands on the couch on either side of Charlie’s thighs. Her bared stomach fluttered uncontrollably. Eyes glued to Charlie’s navel, Genesis said, “Look how tight she is, practically an outie; I love skinny girls.”

“What are you going to do?” Charlie said fearfully.

“Relax, cariño, ain’t nobody gonna hurt you,” she said to Charlie and smiled, her plump red lips gleaming in the lamp light. She was a strikingly beautiful woman, but the blackness of her eyes hid her intention; she seemed at once loving but simultaneously capable of great malice.

Reza said, “Relax, Charlie,” his tone surprisingly reassuring. He leaned back in his chair and put the sole of his shoe up on the edge of the coffee table, slumped a little and watched now, his hand covering his own cock in his suit pants.

“What’s she going to do?” Jonny asked, but no one responded. Strangely, the tension of the situation had worked an excitement into him as well, and he felt a surging stiffness beginning to ache between his legs.

CHAPTER SIX

GENESIS PUT a hand up to cover Charlie's belly, her fingers spread out wide, admiring her own dark color against Charlie's pale freckled skin. "She's so warm, and tight as a drum. I can feel her quivering, feel her organs squirming under my hand." The hand turned to a claw, and she dug her nails into Charlie's hard stomach, the French tips of the expensive manicure digging crescents into her skin. Charlie lightly whimpered and Genesis hissed.

Charlie bit her lower lip and pulled her sweatshirt higher, tucked her chin down so she could watch what this strange woman would do. She didn't wear a bra and the lower curve of her breasts were bared, nipples still hidden. The hand relaxed on her stomach, fingertips smoothing over the little scoops she'd left impressed in her skin.

"Kiss it better," Genesis whispered to herself, and she plumped her lips, pressed them to Charlie's stomach and she made another high frightened sound, sucking her stomach in further. She softly kissed her stomach, did it carefully and suckled her flesh, pulled on it with the suction of her mouth. She pulled back and whispered now, "That's where the baby is made," her sleepy eyes watching Charlie's stomach—smeared with the sheen of her saliva and the imprints of her bright red lipstick. "You're a beautiful girl," Genesis said to her, eyes up to meet Charlie's now.

Charlie mouthed, “Thank you,” her mouth dry and frightened and no sound coming out.

Genesis returned her attention to Charlie’s tummy, stuck out her pink tongue, and it quavered in a point, poised above her navel. Then it dove in and scooped around its shapes. Charlie made soft breathy noises like she was hyperventilating, her eyes wide, pupils dilated. Genesis now dove in, clamping the ring of her lips against Charlie’s stomach and suckled loudly. Charlie’s eyes went wider, but she looked straight ahead, not at Reza but beyond him, her focus on what this woman did with her mouth on her navel stealing all her faculties for the moment.

The woman began a feline purr, slowing her mouth, pulling away with a shimmering strand of saliva connecting her lip to Charlie’s skin, eyes lowered to her navel. She sucked on her lips, that bright lipstick rubbed off, her own lips an excited berry color. Her fingers ran the crinkled waistband of Charlie’s pajama pants, then took up the dangling pink ties and unwound them.

“Hey wait,” Charlie said excitedly, “I don’t know ...”

“I have to see ...” Genesis said, eyes turned up to Charlie pleadingly.

“I don’t know,” Charlie whispered.

Reza said, “Let her,” and Charlie’s mouth twisted up again, her brow pinched low.

Genesis untied the strings and loosened the waistband by running her fingers underneath it and pulling it away from Charlie’s stomach. Now with fingers purposely hooked into the very front of her pajama pants’ waist, tucking under the fronts of her panties as well, she pulled them out and peered inside. It made her smile, and she drew a deep breath, inhaling Charlie’s scent. She said, “Mm, you had sex today.”

“No,” Charlie protested, then amended: “Kind of.”

“Tate get you so hot?” Genesis said and winked.

“No,” Charlie said, “Jonny and I messed around.”

Reza scoffed then laughed silently, shoulders shaking.

“Messed around, huh?” Genesis said and tugged the pants out further.

“We didn’t have sex,” Charlie said, Jonny wondering why that was anyone else’s business.

“I can smell you came, Charlie,” Genesis sneered.

Charlie shrugged. “I did.”

“Good for you, Jonny,” Reza said, eyebrows raised like he was impressed. Now Jonny shrugged.

Genesis kissed Charlie’s navel again, working lower, tugging on the pajama pants, revealing more and more of her. Charlie fidgeted while she did, still holding her shirt up just below her breasts, but now looking up at the ceiling.

“Open your legs, Charlie,” Reza said, and Jonny saw he was aroused under his pants, that huge tool of his pressing out the fine fabric of his dark tailored suit.

She made another soft whimper, but she complied, her teeth clamped down on that lower lip. Her legs parted and Genesis came around her leg to get between them, get close to her. She kissed more, lowered the pants, her tongue slipping well below Charlie’s navel now. She tugged the pants hard and there was the sound of stitches giving, and Charlie gasped. The woman’s head buried in her lap now, her face pressed in the gap between her pants and her skin and Charlie looked higher up, straight above her, her eyes wide, her mouth hanging open.

Reza said, “Tilt your hips, Charlie.”

She scrunched her brow again, relaxed her body a little, curled her spine, her stomach folding in lines and her pelvis tilted forward.

Genesis’s tongue must have come close to touching her intimate space because she jumped and protested. “I don’t think ... I don’t know about this ... Reza ...”

Genesis raised up, let her pants go, on her knees between Charlie's legs. She chuckled lightly, her face gleaming and then wiping it with the back of her hand. She jutted her chin toward Charlie and said, "I want to see it," her eyes narrowed, watching her under her long, jet black lashes.

Charlie lowered her sweatshirt, her gaze on Genesis, mesmerized. They watched each other for a long moment then Charlie tucked her hands in her pants and pushed them down, leaning forward and pushing them down until they hooped around her ankles. She lay back again but her thighs were clamped together, her knees tightly pressed.

Genesis kissed the points of her pale white knees and raised up again, pushed with her hands to open Charlie's legs and she resisted but only for a few seconds then Genesis had them parting, her black eyes going wide with delight at what was revealed.

She softly exhaled looking between Charlie's legs, liking what she saw. "It's a pretty thing," she sighed. "So pretty. May I pet it?"

"I don't know," Charlie said.

The woman used the back of her hand to stroke up Charlie's exposed sex and she made a soft reluctant sound in her throat.

"Some girls are cherries, some are fudge, some are a dusky rose ..."

Another weird frightened sound from Charlie's throat.

"You're just my tiny little strawberry, *amada*," Genesis said, and before Charlie could say anything, the woman's mouth was between her legs, suckling on her labia.

"Oh no, mm, oh wow," Charlie hummed, her eyes closed, face turned up. The sound was of guilty pleasure, her mouth open and gasping but her brow furrowed with worry.

Genesis head humped and bumped between Charlie's legs, her long, glossy hair rustling against the inside of her pale thighs. Charlie's soft whimpers became grunts that sounded almost like pleasure. But her face was twisted in sorrow and horror. Her hands came together working over

her own thighs, her nails scratching her white skin then touching Genesis's shoulders. She felt the woman's muscular shoulders, slipped the palms of her hands up her neck and put her hands through the woman's hair. It was all done very tentatively, almost as though she didn't want to but couldn't help herself because of the pleasure the woman was giving between her legs.

"I don't think ... I don't think I want this," Charlie gasped.

Reza laughed, said, "I think you do, Charlie. I think you don't like that you like it so much."

"If she doesn't like it, you should make her stop." Jonny said.

"Jonny, Charlie could tell Genesis to stop. She said she doesn't think she wants this and she said it to the room, not to the person doing it. Let her stop it if she wants."

Jonny had a retort but kept it bitten. He hated to be wrong and he hated for Reza to show him up all the time. But he was right, Charlie could just say that this was enough, to put an end to it, but instead she sat next to him on the couch, writhing, hips wriggling, a hot, sexy, older Latin woman's face buried between her thighs, Charlie's pale hands caressing her head. It didn't seem like she really didn't want this. It was disgusting to see her like this. It hurt his stomach. It was like she was being used and it was all his fault. She hated it, but it felt good and for that reason she let it continue. It was so wrong and yet there was something devious inside it for both of them. His own cock, that had been reluctant to grow hard in front of his wife when she used words to humiliate his size, had now risen in spectacular fashion that he would love to show her. It was her sexiness that was doing this. He wasn't drinking too many energy drinks, it was just the developments of the last half year had twisted up his sexuality into a bundled, unmanageable knot. Once this was over he hoped they would both be able to untangle the mess and return everything to normal.

AS CHARLIE'S breaths came quicker, Jonny watching her little chest rise and fall under her heavy sweatshirt, Genesis suddenly rose up, making a loud suckling, smacking noise between her legs. "You are a tasty little thing," she said, her lips and chin and nose gleaming. Charlie's breath still came rapidly and Jonny watched her hips swiveling on the couch. She was naked from the waist down, her bare, exposed, and shaved sex glistening with this woman's saliva. Unable to help himself anymore, he grabbed a pillow and pulled into his lap, slipped a hand underneath to squeeze himself. Across the coffee table from him, Reza watched as well, not so bashful while he handled the distinct outline of his arousal through his pants.

"Open it up for me," Genesis said.

"What?" Charlie whispered.

"You know what I want."

Charlie stared at Genesis for another moment, her hands paused on her thighs. She looked around her, afraid to face Jonny but he saw her pupils glancing at him in her periphery. Then she looked down between her own legs and ran her hands there.

"That's it," Genesis urged, her smile growing wider and biting on her lower lip with a sharp gold canine tooth.

Charlie touched herself, both her long, pale hands between her legs touching her sex. Wet sounds were made as her fingers caressed her pink folds and then she daintily held her plump outer labia and eased them away from her body and parted them like butterfly wings. Jonny could see her hands shaking.

Genesis still watched admiringly then said, "I like the taste of your sex. I like how you taste after your man makes you come."

Charlie struggled to say something, managed, "Thank you." It came out like a timid question.

Jonny squeezed himself hard underneath the pillow.

“Would you turn around for me, sweetheart?” Genesis said.

“Turn around? How?”

But Genesis was already helping her, hooking a hand under one of her thin knees and twisting her so her hips turned, Charlie then getting on her knees on the couch seat, her hands over the seat back. She looked nervously over her shoulder, eyes darting to Jonny. He tried to show her a brave, comforting face.

Genesis said, “Stick your ass out.”

Charlie said, “Stick my ass out?”

Genesis looked over her shoulder to Reza and he gave a silent laugh. He said, “Charlie needs everything repeated. Get used to it.”

Genesis turned around now, she was smiling. She caressed the globes of Charlie’s cheeks and admired her narrow but round bottom. She said, “You know what I’m getting at. I’m gonna eat your asshole. Now stick it out.”

“Jonny,” Charlie whispered, and his eyes rose from where Genesis caressed her ass to meet her gaze.

He shrugged for her, gave her an attempt at a smile, one so weak it faltered before it got off the ground. He mouthed, “I love you.”

“Okay,” Charlie whispered to him. She looked very unsure.

“Stick it out, mami,” Genesis repeated.

“Okay,” Charlie said to her, slowly pushing herself back and lowering her chin to the seat back. She stopped, said, “I didn’t shower after work.”

Genesis chuckled, said, “That’s what I was hoping.”

As Charlie pushed her rump further, lowered her chin so it touched the couch, her forearms resting over the back, Genesis turned to Reza and motioned for him to pass her pink leather purse. It was a big bag filled with what looked like many things, and she pulled from it a silver vibrator that she twisted and brought to humming life.

“What’s that?” Charlie gasped. She tried to dart a glance behind her to see.

Jonny whispered, "It's okay, Charlie. You'll like it."

"Okay, Jonny," she whispered and lay her cheek on her forearms, her tangled hair covering up her face but her eyes watching his. He leaned a little closer and rubbed her upper arm.

Genesis got low, examined Charlie's pretty petals, wet her fingers with her tongue, touched her there, stroking her fingers up and down. Charlie made troubled faces. Then Genesis took the point of the long silver vibrator and pressed it to Charlie's opening. She jumped and yelped breathily.

Reza laughed, and Genesis joined him. Jonny may have laughed as well if his stomach hadn't got so tight. He whispered, "It's okay."

Charlie said, "What was that?"

"A vibrator," Jonny said.

Charlie nodded, laid her cheek on her arms again and watched him. Genesis tried it another time, taking the humming chrome vibrator and pressing it to Charlie's opening. She frowned and her mouth fell open. Then with surprising ease, thumb and first two fingers brought to a point on the vibrator's base, Genesis slid at least seven inches inside his wife. Charlie sang a sweet and tremulous note of pleasure. Her brows rose high, her eyes closed, her mouth open in a gasping O.

"Oh Jonny, oh wow," she sighed.

Jonny's fingers tingled, and he felt lightheaded. The sight of Charlie delivered purposeful pleasure like this by such a strange intruder in their home was exciting. Under the pillow in his lap, he began to fondle himself.

Genesis pressed her lips in the center of one of Charlie's perfectly round haunches and kissed her there. Did the same on the other side, Charlie beginning to squirm with the feel of the woman's lips on her sensitive bottom. A few silver inches of the vibrator's base still protruded from her opening, and now Genesis, with her clicking bright red diamond studded nails, twisted the base and brought the humming louder. Charlie sang a tight, warbling note. It made Jonny reel again.

“Oh Jonny, oh Jonny,” Charlie mumbled underneath the sound of her fingernails scratching on the couch’s fabric.

When Genesis spread the whole of her glistening tongue over Charlie’s anus—dipped it down, up again, down, then sweeping all the way up to her tailbone—Charlie moaned, and her feet curled up into tight balls; she kicked her legs a little.

The woman went to work on his wife. With her hands curled on the curve of Charlie’s bent over bottom she worked her tongue through every part of her, every crease, every nook and cranny, moving around the vibrator and flicking at her folds, up again and then pressing the tip inside Charlie’s anus. She even suckled on it, forming a tight seal around Charlie’s tight, pink aperture and sucking.

Charlie’s feet stayed curled, her legs kicked, and the longer it went on the more animated her reception became. She scratched at the back of the couch, she thrust her rump out to meet Genesis’s tongue; sometimes she would gasp out, sometimes she would moan, and other times she would cry. Her head was thrust back, her hair would shake, her eyes stayed closed and her mouth stayed open. The woman worked her over until Charlie orgasmed with an explosive wail. Her body bucked and jumped, she thrust forward to get her sex away from this woman’s invasive tongue, then thrust it back eagerly, Genesis complying and digging the point of her tongue inside her again. She grabbed fistfuls of the back seat of the couch until her hands shook, her long neck was bowed gracefully, her chin up to the ceiling as she babbled beautiful nonsense. Jonny buckled as well, his cock flexing in his hand, so close to an orgasm just watching hers that he hunched forward to stop it from happening. Instead it flexed over and over in his grip pumping out clear excitement.

CHAPTER SEVEN

WHEN IT WAS OVER, Charlie left slumped with her head on the back of the couch, face turned to Jonny but her expression one of unconsciousness, Genesis slowed her ministrations and gently kissed her bottom, working her way up to the soft divots at the small of Charlie's back.

"Ooh, you come good, mami," Genesis purred. Charlie whimpered softly, her gentle sounds barely audible over the vibrator still humming, inserted deeply inside her. Now Genesis crouched down and sat on her own heels, began to lick at the soles of Charlie's feet. Her hands searched around her and found her purse, brought it to her lap and she sat upright, put her hands inside.

Jonny reached to Charlie and gripped her arm, rubbing his thumb on her. Her eyes fluttered, opened, and he saw her glassy gaze.

Genesis removed something heavy from her bag and dropped it on the floor at the foot of the couch. He couldn't see what it was, just a jumble of leather straps. She stood up now behind Charlie and stepped out of her very high heels. She took the hem of her tight pink dress and brought it up her body and threw it aside. Completely naked now, she stood behind Charlie. Her body was bronzed, muscular, squat but incredibly vivacious. A tiny narrow waist and a hard muscled belly with a gleaming jewel pierced in her belly button. Her sex was unshaved; a thatch of unruly blackness. One arm

was completely tattooed the other with just a few emblems; writhing snakes and dragons it looked like. One whole leg was practically inked, working from the ankle up her calf twisting at her knee to come up the front of her thigh. At her hipbone was a crude heart-shape with an arrow through it and underneath it said Fuck you, too. She caught him looking at her and it frightened him. She smiled.

“You okay, Charlie?” he asked his wife, his eyes still on this woman and what she might intend to do next.

“Yeah,” Charlie sighed. Eyes fluttering again, she opened them and gave him a weak smile.

Genesis had bent over and grabbed her bundle of straps, brought them to her waist. He saw what it was now. As she snapped the straps around the tops of her thighs and her waist, between her legs dangled an enormous rubber erection. A strap-on dildo.

The woman dropped over Charlie’s back, getting on all fours and clinging to her. Knees up on the couch on either side of Charlie’s ankles she caressed Charlie’s shoulders. She said in Charlie’s ear, “I hear if Reza fucks you tonight you’ll get pregnant.”

“What?” Charlie said, then remembered Reza calling her out for having to have things repeated. “It’s the middle of my cycle,” she whispered.

“That’s all right, sweetheart, don’t worry,” Genesis said. “He also told me you like them big.”

“Like what big?”

Genesis reared up, stayed on her knees and reached around and down, grabbed the top of her purse and hoisted it up to the seat. She said “You like big cock.”

“No, I don’t,” Charlie said, eyes closed, brow lowering.

From her purse Genesis withdrew a small tube. She withdrew the vibrator from Charlie, going slow and doing it carefully. Charlie’s frown lowered, and she moaned. Genesis tipped up the small tube, squeezed it, a

stream of sticky clear gel fell in globs over its tip. Then the vibrator was brought to her slick opening, Charlie reacting to its feel again, pushing back as though she wanted it inside her. But Genesis traced the point higher until it pressed on Charlie's anus.

"Oh, no," Charlie gasped. Her eyes stay closed but her mouth fell open in expectation. Once again, protesting but not preventing.

The vibrator was gently pushed, worked in then out, in again deeper, getting its surface coated with the lubricant before Genesis was able to insert it deep inside her. Charlie groaned now, this time hiding her face from Jonny in the crook of her arm.

"You don't like big dick?" Genesis asked, now hefting the big tool that dangled between her legs. It was a realistic molding, dark brown to match her own skin tone, circumcised with a massive prow-shaped glans. Veins wriggled its surface and Jonny wondered who on earth could have modeled that monster. It looked bigger than Reza.

"No," Charlie moaned.

Genesis stroked lube up and down the shaft of her imitation manhood, watching her own hand work and speaking absently to Charlie, saying, "Every girl loves big dick. You're just saying that 'cause your husband's here."

"No, I'm not," Charlie sighed.

Genesis curled over Charlie's back again, and still stroking the dangling member and saying, "Your husband had a big one, you'd a told me now. He don't satisfy you?"

"He satisfies me," Charlie said. "It's more than sex."

"I'm sure it is, Charlie," she said, stroking the tip of the dildo up and down Charlie's opening, just below the protruding silver end of the vibrator in her anus.

Charlie's hands gripped at the soft couch fabric again, and her chin came up her eyes opening. "It is," Charlie said. "It is."

THE MUSCLES of Genesis's haunches flexed as she slowly drove the huge thing inside Charlie. She withdrew and plunged again, slick wet sounds over top of the vibrator's buzzing. Charlie's eyes rolled up and fluttered, her mouth hanging open again. Genesis worked her hips, muscles of her stomach flexing as she did, stroking it in and out of Charlie in tiny increments. She felt Charlie's back while she did, over the sweatshirt, her hands moving up her spine, rubbing her shoulders and coming down her ribs to squeeze at her waist. She drove herself deeper then and Charlie cried out. Withdrew and plunged again, and Jonny watched where the thick imitation cock spread his wife wide and how her tight sex clung eagerly to it. Charlie *did* like it. Charlie liked it *big*. Under the pillow, his hand slipped inside his sweatpants and found himself wet and throbbing. He gripped himself but refused to stroke.

"You get any work done today?" Reza asked.

"What?" Jonny grunted. It took great effort, but he pulled his eyes from this beautiful woman fucking his wife with a strap-on to look at Reza who sat across the table still slumped in his chair, rubbing his huge arousal through his pants. He watched Jonny. "You a good boy today?"

"Yeah. Sure."

"Too bad. I could keep this going as long as I want and love every minute of it."

"It won't be long," Jonny said, though the reality was he didn't know how long it would be. How much more of this could he take? He watched as Genesis now eagerly thrust in and out of Charlie and she gasped and writhed, swaying her own hips, her spread out sex making wet sounds, the vibrator buzzing from inside her body. It was crazy. All so over-the-top crazy and he couldn't believe that they found themselves here. It started out so simple. Just go down on their landlord and we'll get through this. Now

look where they were. Solely in debt to the landlord, tens of thousands of dollars, held on a string now and his wife their landlord's sex puppet. They wedged themselves further and further into a crack looking for light on the other side, both of them sure there was something to get to, but now he hoped there still would be. After nights like tonight, what would be left of them when they popped through on the other side?

Genesis curled tighter to Charlie, thrusting that big thing further inside her, so close now Jonny couldn't see it going inside. Genesis's hips touched Charlie's buttocks and worked in circles, the thing embedded deep inside her and merely stirring in her guts now. The beautiful Latin woman bit on Charlie's back between her shoulder blades, ran her tongue through her hair and squeezed her shoulders. She worked her hands underneath Charlie's sweatshirt, pushed it up higher and higher, bared her back, bit at the skin and grabbed her hanging little breasts while she continued to fuck her.

"These girls are going to kill me," Reza groaned, and Jonny saw him now gripping his erection going crossways over one leg, holding it with both hands.

"Me too," Jonny said inaudibly.

Both hands ran through Charlie's hair and Genesis gathered it up in a ponytail, pulled her back so that her spine bowed and she pushed herself inside so deep Charlie cried out. Genesis arched her back too, pushed it even deeper and Jonny couldn't believe the size of that thing could be fully inside his wife. But it was. Pushed deep inside her and Charlie loved it.

Back arched and muscles gleaming with sweat, Genesis posed like a cowboy with eight seconds to bust this bronco, one muscular arm extended to grip a gathered ponytail of Charlie's hair, the other placed on the small of her own back. She held herself rigid for Charlie, and Charlie did all the work now. Rolling her hips, swiveling in circles sucking and bouncing on that huge thing buried inside her. She cried and moaned, and her face looked like it was the worst thing and the best thing that ever happened to

her. Her face twisted in a passionate sneer, her mouth hanging open, her teeth opening and closing with a small clicking sound.

“Oh gosh, oh wow, oh gosh, mm gosh,” Charlie began singing over and over. Her own little waist wriggling, pushing herself back on the huge fake penis buried inside her, making herself come. The wriggling became bouncing, bouncing became a deep impaling, and Charlie’s whole body tensed; went rigid and shaking. She cried a long creaking dragging moan as she orgasmed again.

“That’s it, Charlie, that’s it,” Genesis said letting the ponytail go and caressing the center of her back. Still keeping herself rigid, still pushing her hips so Charlie had that stable totem to push herself against.

When it was over, and Charlie was left heaving for breath, Genesis withdrew the huge erection from inside her with a slick, smacking noise then stroked it up and down the insides of Charlie’s thighs. She got close to her, leaning over her back again and whispered, “Yeah, you don’t like big dick.”

Charlie made more soft whimpering sounds and leaned her weight against the back of the couch. Her sweatshirt had fallen down to cover her back again, her bare round bottom closed around the silver thing inserted inside her. Genesis held it, clicked it off and pulled it out. It came free with a brief belching sound, and Charlie put both hands behind her to cover up her bottom.

“You stroking off under that pillow?” Reza asked abruptly.

Jonny jerked upright. His eyes shifted to see Genesis watching him. He shook his head no. Reza laughed.

“You’re jerking off under the pillow.”

“No, I’m not.”

Charlie rolled to her side, putting her butt down on the couch seat drawing her knees up and watching him. “It’s okay,” she said.

Genesis said, “Take the pillow away.”

Jonny withdrew his hand from inside his pants, trying to dry them on the fabric as he went. He moved the pillow and looked down. The front of his pants were baggy enough to hide his arousal.

Genesis said, "Pull 'em down, let me see what you got."

Charlie jumped up. "Oh no, no, no, no. Seriously, no." She walked on her knees to get in front of Jonny and get herself between her husband and Genesis. She held her hands up protectively. "Please, no. No. I'll do anything."

Genesis laughed, said, "What do you think I'm gonna do to him?"

"Please, don't do anything to him. I'm begging you. Okay?"

"He can't even show me what he's working with?" Genesis smiled.

"He's my husband. He's not part of this. Not in that way. I'll do anything. But nobody can touch him."

Genesis shrugged and smirked. "Who said I was going to touch it?"

"I'll do whatever you want," Charlie said. Jonny reached up and held her waist over top of her bunched up sweatshirt. She leaned back against him, sat in his lap and he pushed the tip of his arousal against her bottom. "It's okay, Charlie. Don't worry," he whispered.

She flicked her chin toward him, looking over her shoulder. "It's not okay, Jonny. You're my husband. You're mine."

Genesis unbuckled her harness, the big dick between her legs nodding up and down and sideways, glistening with Charlie's insides from tip all the way to the base. When it was undone, she tossed it to the floor next to her purse. She put her hands on her hips now and looked at Charlie, saying, "You'll do anything, you'll get on that bed."

Charlie nodded.

CHAPTER EIGHT

WHEN CHARLIE STOOD up with Genesis, Reza did as well. His large phallus was visible against the inside of his pant leg, swollen and engorged but pointing down to one side. He handled it. One hand out to Charlie, he guided her around the coffee table, but stopped her there. Genesis joined from behind.

Charlie's baggy sweatshirt hung down below her ass to the tops of her thighs and Genesis stood behind her, tucked her fingers under the hem and lifted it up. Charlie complied, putting her hands over her head and the muscular woman pulled it away and tossed it back to the couch. Charlie stood facing Reza, both hands folded across her tummy shyly, her chin tucked down. Genesis admired her from behind, looking at her pale freckled skin, her narrow shoulders and slim back, her tiny waist, the swell of her rounded ass cheeks. She took a handful of Charlie's apricot mane and held it to her mouth and nose, deeply inhaled and enjoyed it.

"She is so fine," she said to Reza.

Reza nodded in agreement, looked over his shoulder to Jonny and said, "Come take a seat by the bed, Jonny." He sneered, put a hand on the small of Charlie's back and guided her toward the bed, stopped to turn back. "You can come and jerk off while you watch, if that's your thing."

“No,” Charlie whispered. She looked to Reza with concern, then over her shoulder at Jonny and gently shook her head no.

Reza said, “I don’t think your wife wants you to do that.”

“I don’t want her to see it,” Charlie whispered.

“Believe me, honey, I seen plenty.” Genesis said.

“I just don’t want you to see my husband’s,” Charlie said softly without looking at her.

Reza winked at Jonny and said, “Bring your pillow, Jonny. I didn’t want to see your little dick, anyway.”

“I’m not going to jerk off,” he said defiantly.

As Genesis took the small of Charlie’s back and walked her to the bed now, Reza hung behind, turning to say, “Too bad, Jonny. Though I probably gotta tell you: you’re gonna come in your pants anyway when you see what we do to your wife tonight.”

Charlie’s step faltered, and she turned stiffly, her face tense. She said to Reza, “What are you going to do to me?”

“Only good things, little Charlie,” Reza soothed her, though his tone still maintained its menace.

Behind them, Genesis climbed up on their bed and made her way up to the pillows. She sat crosslegged on them and slapped the inside of her thighs, calling Charlie to come and join her.

Reza helped her up onto the bed and Charlie made her way to face Genesis who sat patiently and preened herself. Reza climbed up from the foot of the bed still wearing his suit. Jonny got up from the couch as well, clutching the pillow to his crotch to cover his arousal. He took the back of the chair Reza had been sitting in and dragged it near the bed, turned it around to face.

On the bed, Genesis held Charlie’s face in both her hands and admired her, running her thumbs along the soft pads under Charlie’s wide eyes. Then the woman stood, her legs wide apart and walked herself a little closer to

Charlie, her hairy sex near Charlie's face. Charlie flinched and backed away, saying, "Oh, I don't think I can do that."

"You can, amada, you can and you can do it well. I know you can by the shape of that mouth."

Reza got close behind her, scooting so his chest was at her back. He held her naked waist and stroked his fingers up and down her tummy. He said, "You'll like it, Charlie, you will. This woman was so good to you tonight, you want everything just for yourself?"

"No. I just don't know ... I don't know what to do. I feel ... it makes me feel funny ..."

Genesis stepped closer. Left leg, then the other, her furry mound just inches from Charlie's face. Reza took a hold of the back of her hair and tilted her head upright so that she would face it directly.

Reza growled, "Open your mouth, Charlie."

Charlie gasped, "What do I do?"

Reza said again, "Open your mouth."

The hand that played with her tummy moved higher now, coming up to grip her neck. With a thumb pressed at the corner of her jaw, he held her head at the appropriate angle. Charlie complied, lips parted slightly, eyes open and looking at this other woman's sex. Genesis dipped her knees and brought her vulva to Charlie's open and waiting mouth.

"Use your tongue now," Genesis told her.

While Reza held her neck, Charlie's cheeks moved in and out, Jonny's wife pushing her tongue out and tasting another woman between her legs. He ached to touch himself again, but instead clutched the top side of the pillow tightly as he held it over top of his erection. Charlie made a frowning face, but continued to move her head as she stroked her tongue up and down Genesis's labia.

"Now put your tongue inside a little," Genesis told her, standing with her hands on her hips and looking down her own body at this slender white

girl using her mouth on her. “That’s it. That’s good, right there. Keep doing that. I told you you’d be good.”

“Uh-huh,” Charlie hummed as she continued to push her tongue in and out of the woman. Reza let her throat go, his hand sliding over her naked body, finding both her wrists and guiding her hands up so that they held Genesis’s toned thighs. Charlie’s long and elegant hands stroked up and down the woman’s muscle and now Reza backed away. Charlie continued on her own, moving her head as she sucked on this woman’s vagina and caressed her strong legs.

Genesis took the back of Charlie’s head and guided her deeper, groaning a little. Now she said, “Come with me, follow my pussy,” and stepped backward. Charlie looked up, separated now from the woman’s sex, her mouth and nose gleaming with wetness. Her eyes were wild and bewildered, and she went on her hands and knees and followed along as the woman held her hair and took a step back and sat her butt on the top of the headboard, her feet on their pillows.

Genesis asked, “You gonna make me come?”

Charlie nodded slightly, but not confidently, just telling the woman what she wanted to hear. She was right between her legs now, and her hands came up and rested on the inside of her thighs as she returned her mouth to suckle over top of Genesis’s hairy sex.

Reza got on his knees, unbuckling his belt as he went, unzipping his pants, walking on his knees until he was behind Charlie. He said, “Charlie? —you know I got a surprise for you?”

With her mouth still between Genesis’s legs, she shook her head no while her mouth made wet smacking noises. Genesis showed no expression other than a means sort of smile, looking down to see what Charlie did.

“You want to know what it is?” Reza asked her.

“Uh-huh,” Charlie said.

Jonny watched as Reza, naked from the waist down, hefted his erection and held it in his grip, poking out in the gap between his black shirttails. Slowly, he peeled back his foreskin, angling his cock pointed upright, and it gushed bubbling streams of his pre-come that had been trapped inside his foreskin while he watched Genesis pleasure Charlie with her mouth. It ran down his shaft and he collected it, scooping it up to roll it around his exposed and gleaming glans. Finger still wet, he stroked Charlie from her perineum over her anus. She jumped at his touch there, and it made her disconnect her mouth from Genesis. Over her shoulder, she said, "You can't. You have to wear a condom."

"No, I don't," he said.

"You do. You really do," Charlie said.

"Not where I'm going," Reza said.

"Where are you going?" Charlie asked him.

In answer, Reza tapped on her anus with the big, flared end of his cock. Charlie's legs flexed and her butt cheeks bounced. She looked worried.

"What's my surprise?" she said fearfully.

"You're going to tell me what it is."

"What do you mean?" Charlie asked.

His cock gleamed with wetness, and he pushed down on it as it nestled into Charlie's tight, pink sphincter. He pushed hard enough so the glans disappeared inside, and Charlie groaned and whimpered.

"It's too big," she said.

"You're ready," Reza said, and pushed himself deeper. With his hand out of the way, Jonny could see what he thought the surprise was.

As he sunk deeper inside Charlie, she dug her nails into the insides of Genesis's thighs, and she seemed to like the pain. Charlie cried again, "It's too big."

"It's time, Charlie. I can't go six months without your ass."

“THINGS AREN'T SUPPOSED to go in there,” Charlie said.

Reza wriggled his hips a little, his cock slipping inside her just a little more. He said, “Doesn't it feel good?”

Charlie frowned and made a funny noise in her throat. She moved one hand from the inside of Genesis's thigh and rested it over top of Reza suit jacket where it covered his hip. “It hurts. Your thing is too big.”

“If you relax a little, Charlie, I'm telling you you're going to love it.”

“Ow,” Charlie whispered. But Jonny could see that her thighs flexed, and she pushed herself back against his intrusion. Like she was curious.

“That's it,” Reza said. “You feel it now?”

Charlie nodded slightly but bit on her lower lip.

“I feel it,” Reza said. “Everything on your body is tight, isn't it?”

Charlie gasped a little now, made a soft whimper and nodded. “Careful,” she reminded him.

“You feel it? You feel my surprise?”

“Oh,” Charlie gasped, her nails scratching at the fabric of his clothing. “What's your ... what's your surprise?”

“Push back on me.”

“Mm, ah,” Charlie moaned. “You are so big.”

Reza put the palm of his big hand in the center of her slender back and pushed himself a little deeper. Charlie cried out, retreating from him, burying her face between Genesis's spread legs. With his body leaned forward, his suit jacket opened and covered where he penetrated her. Jonny shifted in his seat to see if he could get a better angle. Reza chased her, pushed himself a little deeper still. Charlie bit a wad on the inside of the woman's thigh, and it made her mewl like a horny cat.

With the flesh still pinched between her teeth, Charlie nodded her head, wanting more.

“Oh, you like it now? You want me to keep going?”

Charlie didn't answer, her bite turning to a suckling as she mouthed the skin near the woman's sex. She made a soft noise that sounded affirmative.

"You're going to tell me what my surprise is."

"I don't know what you mean," Charlie gasped, rested her chin in the seam where Genesis's thigh met her hip. Genesis caressed Charlie's head, winding her fingers through her long, ginger hair.

Without looking at Jonny, Reza addressed him: "Jonny, bring me her T-shirt. Get the lube off the couch."

He thought of being difficult, of throwing up obstacle—there was something in him that liked railing against Reza sometimes. A little defiance, a little friction between them, was a good reminder that this was an ongoing battle, and while he owned his wife right now, it would not be permanent. So instead, he did what he was told. He stood up with the pillow clasped between his legs—God, his erection was literally throbbing, he could practically feel it through the cushion—and he wound around the chair and made his way to the couch, retrieved the small bottle of lube that Genesis had used to lubricate her strap-on. With that, he made his way to the bed and snatched up Charlie's T-shirt that had been thrown to the floor. But he wouldn't hand it to Reza, instead just dropping it on the bed next to his knee. Reza never looked at him once.

Now Jonny returned to the chair, sat himself in it deeply, and watched. His heart thumped in his chest.

"Easy, Charlie," Reza said and slowly withdrew himself from her rectum.

Charlie kicked her legs a little and curled her toes. With his cock withdrawn, Reza picked up her T-shirt, wrapped it around his enormous member and cleaned it off. Then he took up the bottle of lube and squirted out an undulating line across the top of his huge cock like he was putting ketchup on a hot dog. Between them, Charlie still squirmed, as reluctant as she always made this out to be, she couldn't help the way her body

responded to the attention it received. She swayed her hips and rubbed her thighs together, and with her head firmly clasped between Genesis's hands, she continued to use her mouth on the woman. Reza stroked the lube up and down his huge member then pointed it between her legs again.

When it touched her perineum, then dipped down to poke at her labia, Charlie jerked forward.

"No, you can't."

"Give it to me, Charlie. Just once, in and out."

"You can't, I'm being serious, this is a really bad time."

Reza rubbed her back with his huge hand, caressing her shoulder blade with a thumb. His other hand gripped his cock at the base and he stroked it up and down her entry, making Charlie whimper. He pressed until his huge glans slipped around the ring of her shining labia and disappeared into her body. Charlie moaned now.

"Please, it's a really bad time. I told you, I'll do everything you want, please, don't come inside me."

Reza gave a mean chuckle, said, "You don't want my baby?"

Charlie shook her head, "Gosh, no."

"Relax Charlie, don't you trust me?"

"I don't know," she whispered.

Genesis laughed, and said, "I wouldn't trust him, he's the devil."

"Don't listen to her, Charlie, you can trust me," Reza said as he pushed his hips forward and drove himself inside her just a little bit deeper. He pulled his jacket off and began to unbutton his shirt.

"I'll do the other thing now," Charlie said. "I'll do the other thing now and you can come there."

Reza pulled his shirt off and said, "I just want you to get your surprise."

"What is my surprise?"

Reza's hands went up and down her sides, squeezed her waist and caressed her hunches. One hand in the center of her back he pushed her into

Genesis's crotch and the woman closed her thighs around Charlie's shoulders. Now he pushed himself inside her and Charlie wailed and kicked her feet.

"You feel it?"

"W-what?"

"Feel it?" Reza growled and pushed himself even deeper.

"Oh gosh, oh gosh," Charlie babbled.

"God, you're so fucking tight," Reza said to himself, then gripped Charlie's narrow waist and drove himself fully and deeply inside her.

Charlie wailed again and hooked her arms around Genesis's thighs. "Oh gosh, oh gosh, that feels so good, oh gosh," she murmured in a husky, quick whisper.

Reza balanced his hips against her, his full-size completely embedded in Charlie's body, she rocked with his movement. "You feel it?"

"Oh, yes, mm ... I feel it ..."

"What is it?" Reza growled.

"Mmm, you ... sh-shaved it ..."

"Get up with me," he said now and gripped her arms to pull her upright. She went to her knees, her bare feet folded on either side of his knees. With her back arched and her arms crossed behind her back, she rested her head against Reza's chest. Genesis dropped to her knees in front of her.

Reza said, "That what you wanted?"

"Oh gosh, mm ... yes," Charlie said.

Both of Genesis's hands cupped Charlie's meager bosom, pushed them together then ran her extended tongue in zigzags and circles over both Jonny's wife's hardened and extended nipples.

Charlie went wild. Her hips gyrated, and she made pained mouthing faces, like a caught fish laying on a dock.

"It feels so good," Charlie asked. "It feels so good, it's so big, it feels so good ..."

“I never shaved for no one.”

Charlie said, “It doesn’t scratch, it doesn’t hurt, it just feels so good ...”

Genesis withdrew her suckling mouth, and through narrowed eyes regarded Charlie’s pleasure with a sneer on her face. To Reza, she crooned, “Ooh, she gonna come.”

“Ah,” Charlie gasped. Her breaths had come quicker, and Jonny watched the way her body moved against the huge totem buried up inside her. This was the worst time of the month for her to do this but she couldn’t help herself, his little wife getting off on the worst thing she could do right now.

“She is. She’s going to come,” Reza said, like he was an expert on Jonny’s wife. And in a way, he supposed he was, as terrible as that thought may be.

Genesis cupped Charlie’s cheeks and kissed her fully on the mouth and Charlie whimpered into it. Her hands came around the woman’s back, her pale hand stroking down the tattooed angel wings that covered from shoulder blades to tailbone then grabbed handfuls of her ass. She was sandwiched between two experienced sexual sadists and she surrendered to them. When Genesis withdrew her kiss Charlie cried out with a long, mournful sound of orgasm. Like abounding pleasure ripped through her as she tried to push it away, reluctant to enjoy its awful pleasure. Her wail became a long moan broken up with the sound of sobbing.

She collapsed forward onto Genesis and the woman received her with open arms, hugged around her back and scratched her lightly. Reza did nothing but feed his enormous hard member into her. He didn’t thrust, just stood on his knees with his hands on his hips. Jonny’s wife fully impaled.

Before she was fully out of her orgasm, Charlie was already protesting, “Get it out, please, get it out of me. You have to get it out of me ...”

As Reza withdrew himself fully, Charlie collapsed forward and Genesis turned and let her fall face first onto the mattress. Charlie grabbed up

armfuls of pillow and hid her face. Into them, she moaned, “I shouldn’t have done that, oh no, how could I do that ...? ...”

Reza sat back and lifted up his knees, now he pulled down his pants and threw them on the floor at Jonny’s feet. He got up again, straddled his knees on either side of Charlie’s. She lay face down on the bed completely naked, her bare ass pointed up at them. Reza slapped it lightly, and he dug his thumbs into the roundest part and pulled her seam wide, exposing her tiny butthole. He lowered his hips by spreading his knees wide, bounced his heavy cock until it settled against her sphincter.

“Oh no, oh wow, okay ...” Charlie chanted.

Reza pushed his slippery member slowly inside her and Charlie’s legs kicked up, her heels striking Reza’s hard ass. He lowered himself more, spread his hands out on either side of her pale body. Then with her flat on the bed and face down, he began to bounce his hips up and down against her, each thrust making her haunches shake. His cock looked enormous going in and out of her pushed-together cheeks. The bed got rocking and shaking, the headboard slapping against the wall. Genesis sat herself on the pillows and she gave a mean smile to Jonny. She looked between his legs and nodded her chin to him with a wink. Indicating to him to move the pillow and show her what he had. There was no way he would do that. Wasn’t interested in her taking a look at what he had, just opening himself up for ridicule, and he wouldn’t do what Charlie didn’t want.

His wife lay and took it like a good girl. Occasionally her heels would come up and kick at Reza a little, but she stayed still the whole time, hugging a pillow to her face and whimpering into it as Reza pummeled his huge thing into her bottom.

It didn’t take long, it’d been a long and exciting buildup. In just a few minutes, Reza was huffing and puffing, and then very soon after came breathy animal snorts. He ejaculated inside her then, big strong hands grabbing up fistfuls of their bedsheets on either side of his wife, thrusting

his thick size into her tiniest space, his balls constricting and emptying their contents.

After his grunting and roaring abated, Reza gripped the base of his cock and unsheathed it from Charlie's anus. It exited with a flatulent belch and stayed open for a long moment until her hips settled forward and her cheeks closed. Reza collapsed on his back next to them on the bed.

Genesis ran circles on Charlie's back until she stirred. When her head lifted from the pillow, Genesis said, "You can't tell me you don't like big dick."

Charlie watched her blankly, her watery eyes blinking. Genesis stood, stepped on either side of Charlie's shoulders, and sat herself down on the same pillow where she lay her head. "I'm not finished yet," she said to her.

CHAPTER NINE

GENESIS LEANED her back on the headboard and opened her legs wider. Charlie languidly rose from the bed onto her hands and knees. Her lips kissed the woman on her navel, her tongue then running circles around the diamond stud there. The tongue slipped lower, and Charlie buried her face in the woman's sex.

What she did must've been the right thing, because Genesis's head fell back and rested on the wall. Her eyes closed and her mouth fell open and she made soft clicking noises in her throat. Soon Charlie had her shaking, and the woman had two hooped piercings through her dark brown and engorged nipples. They swiveled and shook the longer Charlie used her mouth.

He could hear his wife's breathing between the woman's legs. Wet sounds, coarse and rasping, desperate for air. Her rump tilted higher and Jonny saw between her legs. Her anus had been reddened, and it flexed in and out as she used her mouth. Reza's semen seeped from it and ran down her labia.

Jonny rose from his chair, and this time he left the pillow, tossing it behind him to sit on the seat. He made it to the bed quickly, hunched over, sat on his hip and picked up the T-shirt Charlie's Reza had cleaned himself with. He took it now and dried his wife. He could feel her buttohole moving

in and out, heaving as her stomach flexed as she tried to breathe with her nose and mouth buried in Genesis's crotch. He dried her good, getting all her folds, making sure that none of Reza's potent seed got inside her.

Over her rump, Jonny watched Genesis's face as she came close to orgasm. Her long fake eyelashes fluttered, and her eyes regarded him. They traveled down between his legs and though he should've covered himself he didn't. He let her take a look for a moment, see the modest tent that his inferior manhood made in the front of his cotton sweatpants. Where the tip crest, the fabric had turned dark from the excitement. When she smiled, he covered it up, ashamed yet aroused.

A whine built in her chest, her breath came faster and she grabbed fistfuls of Charlie's tangled mane, shoved her hips forward and mashed Charlie's face into her sex. She made an unusual sound as she orgasmed, much like a cat, a growling purr that built in her chest then turned to a ravenous mewl.

AN HOUR LATER, Charlie and Jonny were alone in the kitchen.

After Reza had come inside her, and then Charlie used her mouth on Genesis, the three of them had lay on the bed. Reza and Genesis caressed Charlie's body all over. Genesis seemed particularly intrigued by her. Studying her nipples, tugging on them, kissing them, she really liked her navel, too. The woman seemed to have a thing for tummies, just like she had said. Charlie was shy, watching their hands touch her, then thinking she should return the same favor, she let her fingers stroke over Genesis's latte-colored skin. But soon all their movements slowed, the swiping of their hands took longer moments of rest.

Jonny sat in the dark and watched the three of them as they began to each in turn fall asleep. No one had touched him at all. It wasn't until maybe fifteen minutes they were asleep before his erection finally subsided.

Though he wanted to, he refused to pleasure himself. Too easy. Plus, the next time Charlie showed an interest, he didn't want to let her down.

It was sometime after that he himself must've drifted off. Charlie woke him with a gentle kiss on his forehead. When his eyes opened, he saw his wife standing over top of him while he slept in the chair. She was completely bare, smiling at him, then caressing his cheek. She whispered, "I'm hungry."

So, with the two strangers in their lives sleeping in the king-size bed, he stood with his wife—not wearing a thing—by the kitchen table. Their leftovers from dinner were brought out from the fridge and laid out. He ate a cold fried pickle while Charlie stood next to him with a pizza slice in her hand, her second one, chewing and rolling her eyes with pleasure. They were trying to be quiet, so Jonny whispered, "I guess you worked up an appetite."

She ignored the question by saying, "It's really good pizza, isn't it?"

He shrugged, gave her a noncommittal face. It *was* really good pizza but there was no way that he would ever be an Angelo's kind of person. Once Reza was out of their life, they were going to be Domino's people again, no matter how good that tiramisu was.

Charlie held up a can of Coke to her lips, waiting for herself to stop chewing, doing this weird little waiting-dance kind of thing, dipping at the knees and bouncing her head from side to side. Then she swallowed and washed it all down with about a half a can of pop.

He smiled at her, moved closer. He said, "When we started this, you said you didn't want him that way."

"What way?"

"You know what way." He nodded his chin down low with his eyes looking downward. "Back there."

"I know, I didn't. But you know how it is ... Things are changing. This situation isn't like it was when it started."

“I’ll say.”

“We’re going to make it work.”

He nodded, she was right, and he didn’t need to needle her. “Did it hurt? Are you all right?”

“It hurt at first, but it was okay.”

“I thought you didn’t like it back there.”

“I didn’t. I don’t, I guess. Not really.”

“It didn’t seem like you didn’t like it.”

“I don’t know what to say, Jonny. I *don’t* like it. But it’s not *terrible*.”

“It’s so dirty,” he told her.

She nodded, took another bite of her pizza. “I’ll tell you one thing for sure: I don’t like him ejaculating in there.”

“I don’t like him ejaculating *anywhere*.”

She chuckled a little, covered her mouth before he would see food in her mouth when she smiled.

“I’m glad you think that’s funny.”

“We are in this *together*, Jonny,” she said and put her arm around his shoulder, kissed his neck with pizza scented lips. When she went on her toes to kiss his lips a distinct and wet belch came from her bottom. She thumped down on her heels and their eyes met. She looked ashamed, embarrassed. Her features sagged.

He let her off the hook and smiled a little. “Too much pop?”

“Too much pop,” she whispered, and it gave him a warm feeling to see her sweet face smile just a little.

Even though she was completely naked, she took a napkin out of the paper bag that the fried pickles had come in, walked to the wastebasket next to the counter, turned her back to it so she faced him. Then standing there with a pizza slice in one hand, she tucked the other behind her and wiped at her bottom with the napkin. She checked it, shook her head, turned and put her bare toes over the pedal to flip the lid. She dropped the paper in, held it

open for a moment longer, took one more bite of the pizza and dropped the crust in as well. When the lid clapped closed and she turned to face him, she slapped her hands together in alternating swipes, dusting off the cornmeal.

When they were close again, he whispered, “You kissed a girl.”

Sheepish again, she turned her face away from him. “That was easier to take,” he said quietly.

“For you,” she said.

“Sorry. Was it hard ...?”

She thumped her forehead against his chest. “I don’t want to talk about it.”

He stayed close with her for a long moment and just felt her breathe. She whispered, “It was nice of him to shave his penis for me, don’t you think?”

“He’s such a gentleman,” Jonny said and rolled his eyes.

She stepped back and gave him a tentative smile. “I thought it was nice.”

“It was considerate. And he’s not a considerate person.”

“Did you hear Genesis call him the devil?”

“I don’t think she was kidding.”

She peeked to the doorway as if looking to see if they were still alone. She whispered, “His penis does look weird shaved though. The rest of him is so hairy, now he’s got this big bare thing hanging there.” When she said it she mimicked Reza’s big dick by dangling a swaying hand between her legs.

“Are you going to tell him that?”

“No, that wouldn’t be nice.”

“Maybe *I’ll* tell him.”

“Jonny, behave.”

“What?—he thinks he’s the best thing going. He doesn’t—”

Charlie ignored him, smiling as he spoke, then padding over to him, getting close and whispering in his ear. "I'm standing here naked and you're talking about Reza."

"Sorry," he whispered back, wondering why he wasn't the one to think of that.

She got close to him again, up near his ear and cupping her hand just to make sure this was only between the two of them. She whispered, "Can I give you a blow job?"

There was an immediate stirring in his pants. His face darted back so his eyes could meet hers. He nodded solemnly, and she smiled. His beautiful wife, standing next to him naked, sacrificing herself before the great landlord demon, opening every orifice she had for him to fill, doing it for them as a couple. He set her on the path, probably for his own enjoyment, and here she was taking up the reins and bringing them together as one again, doing what it took to get their coach back on the track. She was the greatest and most beautiful thing he could imagine.

Charlie seemed excited at the prospect, still grinning broadly, her eyes practically sparkling in the low, dim light. She hopped around him and peeked down through the pass-through to check if the bad people in her bed were still sleeping. Then she came back tiptoeing, rubbing her hands together. She dropped to her knees, and the excitement froze him. He'd been aroused all evening watching that strange woman come into their apartment and dominate his wife, bent her over the couch and lick her anus, make her come and put dildos and vibrators in her. Watched her go down on another woman for the first time, washed her have anal sex with Reza for the first time. The whole while he was ready to explode. Now here he was with the most giving and loving person in his life, the only human being he ever really did give a shit about, the only one that he felt gave back the love that he himself delivered ... and he was *scared*. Scared he wouldn't get hard, scared he would let her down yet again. This woman that he won,

back when she was in school and he leached computer time for free at the library, a woman that he barely deserved and bent over backwards to prove himself to. Probably in some sense it was his love for her that put them on the rails to destruction. The desire to make easy money ... and that became fraud. Sure, he'd done it for himself, but he'd done it for himself in the sense that it would make him look better to the woman he loved. If he couldn't get hard, what good was he?

Charlie pulled down on the waistband of the sweatpants, got them down mid-thigh, his penis frightened and turtled, his testicles climbed high and protective. A small and meager fleshy offering nestled in wiry pubic hair. So small compared to his wife's dominant master. So small to her dominant master's minions. How could she even like it? Now his hands gripped the edge of the countertop and he thought how terrible it would be if he was small and shriveled like this and just when she wanted it he couldn't get hard. He willed himself, and felt nothing now.

His wife studied what he had, the thing that she'd seen or played with a million times but suddenly now he felt so inadequate. He didn't make as much money as Reza, he wasn't muscular, he wasn't masculine in that way, and he wasn't endowed. He got them in trouble, his deceit had put them in catastrophic debt. And this woman he barely deserved had stood by him. For the first time ever, he wondered if she had made a mistake in doing that.

But his Charlie apparently had no such thoughts, because she smiled at his penis that she looked at point-blank, the thing sticking almost straight out. Then cocked her head and put her mouth over it. The warmth, the wet—it all felt like heaven, but instead of his heart pounding from lust, his heart pounded with worry. He felt the wonderful things she did, felt her tongue slipping up and down the underside, felt the tight suction she formed with her pouting lips. She pulled it back, clamped in the ring of her mouth, teased it, sucked on it. Nothing was happening. Now his upper lip began to sweat.

The more she worked it, the more worried he became. He could feel himself—despite the wonderful things she did—constricting even more. His penis became less pliable, his testicles climbed higher. His brow furrowed, and he sneered, closed his eyes, tilted his chin to the ceiling and squinted his eyes until he saw stars. In the stars he tried to conjure the worst possible images. This morning when his wife had sucked Reza's balls until he came, how she kept his load trapped in his foreskin then peeled it back and put it in her mouth; she'd given a handsome, muscular, and well hung guy a hand job today—this very day she handled another man until he ejaculated; pictured again his frail little wife with her legs together, face down on the bed and hugging a pillow to her face while some half-animal half-man with the hugest cock he'd ever seen shoved it in and out of her bouncing bottom.

That stirred something. He felt a stiffening and although it wasn't in his penis, it was a hard lump somewhere near his prostrate and at least it was *something*.

He could breathe again, he flexed his ass cheeks, tried to use his muscles to pump up what he had. It wasn't working, but it was better than nothing, right? He looked down now and looked at her sweet face, but that was a problem—her brow was bunched with worry. It was bunched because her husband couldn't get hard. Now that mild arousal he felt was challenged and started to shrink away. He was going to let her down again. So he grabbed the sides of her head and gently caressed her, stroked his nails over her sweet scalp, and whispered, "I love you, Charlie."

Charlie sighed and her bobbing and tugging mouth slowed. She pulled it back, stretched his penis out, let it go and it shook and jiggled. She looked up at him and he could see sadness in her eyes. She licked her lips then bit her lower lip.

"Keep going," he told her, "keep going, it's getting there ..."

She held his gaze for a moment, and though he knew he was failing her he didn't see that in her eyes. What he saw was endless compassion for him.

Sure, he frustrated her today, and she even thumped her little fist on the bed, but that was because she was worried *she* was letting *him* down. They could work this out together when she looked at it this way.

“It’s okay,” he whispered. “I swear, just keep going.”

She stood up and let her naked body rest against him, she kissed at his neck and snuggled her face near his ear. Now her hand came down, and she formed a ring tight ring around where his glans met his shaft. She whispered to him: “I know it works, Jonny. I know it does. We’ll figure this out.”

“You turn me on so much, Charlie.”

“I know I do. You like it, Jonny? Like it when you watch me?”

“I guess I do,” he admitted.

“You like watching me get ... *fucked*?” This last word was a barely audible whisper, his wife wanting to tease him but still unsure of the bad words.

He moaned a little and leaned his head so that his jaw touched her cheek.

“You like Reza to fuck me with that big, huge cock?” She flicked the ring up and down the flared rim of his cock head.

“I hate it.”

“I hate it too, Jonny. I hate it, I hate it when he fucks me with that big thing. I hate that it feels so good ...”

Now he groaned again, put his arm around her waist, let his hand dip low, stroked his fingertips over the softness of her mound. She snuggled closer to him.

“Gosh, though, Jonny ... He fucks me so good I come ...”

He hated that this turned him on. He hated that this man did it to his wife all the time, hated that what she said was true—but mostly he hated that this new revelation was more than dirty talk meant to arouse him, worried that there was a truth in it, that she meant it, meant that it *did* feel

really good. Though wasn't he crazy?—of course it felt good, she really did have an orgasm almost every time he put that thing inside her.

"I hate this is working," he sighed. And sure enough it was. More than just a swelling between his legs, there was a growing turgidity in his penis. Charlie noticed it as well, and though he didn't have anywhere near as much as Reza did, she was able to form a fist around what he did have. She looked down at him now, and whispered, "If only you had what Reza had between your legs ..."

"Oh shit, Charlie," he sighed and his head fell back. It was so embarrassing that this worked. It was so embarrassing that his wife had figured it all out now, knew that he liked to watch her with another man. A much more dominant and capable man. Why would that turn him on? In his heart, he was a *man*. He was competitive, he was mean, he had a bad temper ... He *was* a man. He wanted success, he liked to fuck with people, and he liked to win. He wasn't some low testosterone, meek sort of fellow who wasn't able to please his woman. Before any of this had ever transpired, he pleased Charlie plenty. Sure, he had been her only man ever, but he made her feel good. She was timid at first, didn't really like to have anal sex with him, wasn't a big fan of using her mouth. But they still got it done. They still had a good time between the sheets. As he stiffened further, he realized the changes in the last months. She took anal now, not so willingly, but submitting just the same. And in some sense *liking* it. Oral? Sure. Big, ugly, grotesque horse cock in her mouth? Sure. Come in her mouth? Sure. She'd done it to Demetrius, too. God, these awful thoughts were really working. He grew to hardness in her hand.

She whispered, "If that's what makes it work, Jonny, I guess that's what we'll have to do for now."

"You don't like it?"

"I just want things to be the way they were, when it was just you and me. Remember the fun we used to have, Jonny?"

“I’m sorry, Charlie, I’m sorry how this all turned out, I wish—”

The bathroom door closed.

Charlie stopped. Her hand gripped his erection, practically closing around it. They both looked down at what she held, then up at each other, their eyes darting. They stayed quiet.

“Hold on,” she whispered in his ear.

She left him then, let him go, trotted to the pass-through and peeked down. She looked toward him, said, “Reza’s in the bathroom.”

She came back to him, said, “We should go back down.”

“We can finish. Charlie, look, I’m hard ...” Though when he looked down he saw that it had already dwindled.

Charlie said, “I don’t think we should.”

“We’re husband and wife, we can do whatever we want. The deal isn’t that I can’t be with you ...”

“I know it’s not. I don’t think he likes it though,”

“Who cares what he likes. You’re my wife.”

“He can make things difficult, Jonny. When we get together, it should be when he’s not around.”

He looked at her sweet face looking at him hopefully, wishing to convey to him the stress it gave her that Reza was awake and around. His erection had failed anyway. Shrunk down again, only half-aroused now.

“It’s so unfair.”

“I agree, Jonny. All of this is very unfair. But it’s the way it is,” she said, nodding her head and locking eyes with his. “We can make it work if we’re together. Remember.”

He picked up her hand and held it between both of his and kissed her fingers. Kissed her engagement ring diamond.

“I have to go, okay, Jonny?” she said.

“Whatever.”

“Don’t be like that, Jonny. I *have* to go down there.”

“Fine. You’re right. Go on ahead, I’m going to stand here for a minute.”

She looked at him, troubled for a moment, went on her toes and kissed his cheek. “I love you, Jonny.”

CHAPTER TEN

WITH HIS ELBOWS on the counter, watching over the pass-through, he saw Charlie trot down, her pale, slender figure almost luminous in the seeping city-blue lights, and she tiptoed back to the bed and climbed into it, carefully scurrying up to lay next to Genesis. She bunched up a pillow under her head and curled up in a fetal position facing the bathroom door.

From behind that door, the toilet flushed. The line of light at the floor switched off, the door opened, and Reza came out as naked as Charlie. He was a squat, muscular shape in the low light, but you could make out the hair covering his chest and stomach. Between his legs, his shaved genitals were prominent. He used to have long, scraggly pubic hair that hid most of his size; tufts actually growing down the shaft. But now that he was shaved, it did look larger and more intimidating, but strangely *bare*. It seemed it also shaved his scrotum. His genitals looked stark against the rest of his furred body

Reza cocked his head seeing Charlie back in bed. He said, “Where were you?”

“Pizza,” Charlie whispered.

Reza had the same thought as Jonny. “Work up an appetite?”

Charlie nodded her head on the pillow.

Reza walked to the bed and climbed up on it, laying next to Charlie, her in between the two of them. With his hand caressing her thigh, he said, "You had quite a workout."

"I did," Charlie agreed.

Reza lay down next to her facing her, his hand stroking over her body.

Jonny hated seeing it and he huffed an exasperated breath, looked away, lifted off the counter and put away the pizza box and the fried pickles, and the tray of tiramisu which they hadn't even touched. Though he wouldn't have minded having a piece but now that Reza was up he'd lost his appetite.

When he came back down to the living area and made his way to the chair still sitting next to the bed, he saw Genesis was awake as well. The arousal he had in the kitchen and that was difficult to provoke had dwindled, but sitting down in the chair now and looking across and seeing his naked wife behind the beautiful, undulating shape of Genesis sparked something inside him again. He brought the pillows to cover.

Genesis and Charlie were talking in low voices but he could make out what they were saying. While they spoke, Reza lay on his side behind Charlie propped up on one elbow. His hand went up and down her leg and would run circles over her belly button. He also bit on her shoulder.

Charlie was saying, "Thank you. You're beautiful, too."

With a handful of Charlie's long, curling locks, Genesis held them to her mouth and nose again and said, "You have the most beautiful hair."

Charlie said sheepishly, "Thank you."

"I know I'm your first woman."

Charlie's eyes darted over Genesis's face, and she sucked on her lip a little before saying, "Yeah."

"You like it?"

Charlie squinted and made a funny face. She took the lock of her hair away from Genesis and covered her mouth and nose, her eyes still watching her and blinking. "I don't know," she whispered.

“I’m glad I had you. You are quite an experience.”

“I was?”

“You ate me out good.”

At this, Jonny knew Charlie would have gone red if he could see her face. She hid herself away and groaned, turned her face so that it was in the pillow. Genesis took her shoulder and rolled her so that she would look up.

“You have nothing to be bashful about, my sweetheart.”

Behind Charlie, Reza chuckled.

Eyes still on Genesis, Charlie slowly removed the hair and let herself be seen. Her mouth worked around a little then she said, “It was nice.” The word nice was almost inaudible.

“I could tell. It’s nice to hear.”

They still stared at each other for a long moment, their eyes locked on each other. At last Charlie said, “What’s that thing down there?”

Genesis moved higher up the pillow, propped up on an elbow like Reza, the two of them looking down on their prey like experienced predators. “Tell me what thing you mean?”

Charlie’s chin tucked to her chest, and she looked down both their bodies, looking between Genesis legs. “The thing you have there.”

“Touch it.”

Charlie didn’t protest, and though Jonny couldn’t see what her hand did, his wife must have slid up one of Genesis’s thighs because they parted slightly and then she touched her between her legs.

Charlie said, “It’s a diamond.”

“You like it?”

Charlie nodded a little. “But what is it?”

Genesis said, “It is a diamond. It’s pierced through me. Over my clit.”

“Pierced?” Charlie said with a certain distress in her tone.

“A VCH piercing,” Genesis said. “Vertical Clitoral Hood.”

“Why would you do that?”

“Isn’t it beautiful?”

Charlie’s eyes were downturned and her hand was manipulating something that Jonny couldn’t see. He liked to imagine her long, pale fingers teasing the diamond at the apex of the woman’s slit. “It is.”

Genesis said, “Behind the diamond is a metal bar and on the end of the bar is a round metal bulb.” Charlie still played with the piercing but now her eyes moved up to meet Genesis’s. Genesis continued, “That bulb presses on my clit, like, all day long.”

“All day long?” Charlie gasped, her eyes wide as she imagined what that would be like.

“Gets me off twenty-four-seven.”

“It does? Really?”

“You want one?”

Charlie’s hand darted back, and she gave a fearful and funny smile. “No way,” she gasped.

Genesis made a purring sound, much like a cat enjoyed teasing her prey. “Oh you don’t wanna feel good all day long? Standing there at the library, shifting those white thighs from side-to-side? I bet you could make yourself come three times while you was getting paid.”

“At work?” Charlie gasped in a high wheeze.

Genesis ran her nails down Charlie’s stomach between her legs. Charlie didn’t flinch this time, looked down at what the woman did with her hand, parted her legs, even putting one foot flat on the mattress her knee pointed to the ceiling.

“You do have one of the most beautiful pussies I ever seen. You want one, you come to me, I do it for you you won’t feel a thing. I do it for free.”

Reza groaned at Charlie’s shoulder and bit her there. “I’ll buy your pussy a diamond,” he said.

Charlie smiled, her face held in tense half-mirth, unsure if they were teasing her. “I could never,” she said.

Genesis's fingers continued to tease Charlie's folds, and Jonny could hear a stickiness now. "You don't wanna come all day long?"

With his big fingers gripping Charlie's narrow shoulder he turned her over, and said, "She wanted to come all day long, she knows where to find me," and it made Genesis laugh.

Now Charlie lay on her back between the two, her head on the pillow but turned to face Reza. He sneered at her, black eyes twinkling in the dim. They looked at each other for a moment, then Reza reached down between his legs and lifted his heavy, flaccid member and dropped it on to Charlie's thigh. Shaved now, it looked too big to be real, laying over her thigh in a big wrinkled mess, and folded almost in a U-shape, the tip puckered in a nest of twisted foreskin membranes. All three of them looked at it, this big dark brown thing laying on her pale freckled skin.

Reza said, "You didn't thank me."

"I didn't?"

"No, you didn't, you bad girl."

"Are you sure? I think I did—I meant to say it. I really do appreciate that you did that."

"Show me."

Charlie stayed under his gaze for a second, her top canine scratching again at her pouted lower lip. Then she turned, faced him, put her mouth on his chest and kissed her way down his hard, muscular torso. It bothered Jonny, seeing her do this, engaging in some foreplay, teasing him. Why would she kiss the muscles of his belly when all the man wanted was her mouth on his cock?

With her face buried in his crotch, Genesis curled up behind Charlie, admiring her back again. The point of her finger began to draw lines on Charlie's shoulder blades, swooping arcs that danced in the middle of her back up to her shoulder and down her ribs to her waist. It made Charlie giggle. Genesis did it over and over, and Charlie's legs began to jump

because she was ticklish. She turned her face over her shoulder and said to Genesis, “That tickles—what are you doing?”

“You the one that needs angel wings. I want to draw them on you.”

Charlie watched over her shoulder at Genesis timid, she said, “I like your tattoos.”

“You come see me. I’m a give you my number, you come see me. We’ll put a little diamond in your pussy and I’ll draw the wings down your back my little angel deserves.”

Charlie’s eyes went wide, and she visibly shivered. Jonny turned to steel now. Why couldn’t his wife be between his legs?

Genesis drew a wing again, on the other side now, and Charlie giggled again, squirmed a little, and Reza pulled her up so she covered his lap, her chest laying across his thighs. She looked up at him and said, “Thank you for doing that. I really appreciate it. When you went deep, your hair really did scratch at me, so thank you.”

Reza seemed to smile, his cheeks pulling up and the points of his thick mustache raising. Jonny had seen Reza smile before, he did it quite often, though those times it was more menace than mirth. Sadistic, mean sort of smiles, bordering on a sneer. The smiled he showed Charlie now seemed like something honest. It seemed very strange, and it put a hard lump in Jonny’s chest.

Reza’s hand tilted up Charlie’s chin, her lips parted and the two of them kissed. Their mouths sealed together, their breaths scoring through their noses—a long lingering kiss, and when they parted, they looked in each other’s eyes. Reza said, “You’re welcome.”

Charlie looked stunned. Caught in his gaze, still looking at him with her lips parted, unsure of the feeling that the kiss had put in her. She blinked a few times, rapidly, her face flinching a little. She licked her lips, and said, “It looks really good,” her voice sounding a little weak and shaky.

“You like it?” he asked her.

“I do,” Charlie said. She slipped off to his side, her head on his chest, her body curled against him. Genesis joined them. Charlie’s hand stroked down his hard stomach and lifted up his penis. It had grown considerably, lengthened but still floppy, she cradled it. “It looks even bigger now.”

Jonny watched her face, watched her as she looked with lowered eyes almost in reverence at the masculine thing she held in her pale, feminine grip. Giving him good words about his genitals. Telling him it looked good, telling him how big it was. Different from what she told him in the kitchen. In the kitchen they shared a joke about him. Was she kidding then or was she kidding now? Who was she fooling? In his heart he knew she was truthful with him, but a dark twisted part of him enjoyed considering that she wasn’t. What if he was the one that Charlie fooled?

His wife’s hand stroked up and down Reza’s flopping member. It squished and squirmed in her grip, the ugly end of it puckering and peeling back, Reza’s hole winking at Jonny. Genesis began to kiss Reza’s chest, starting with his nipple, working down his ribs and over his hard stomach. Reza looked like a barbarian king, laying back with two concubines pleasuring him, both of them laying in the crook of his arm, their bodies pressed against him his muscular arms draped over their backs. He looked like a powerful conqueror painted on an old sword and sorcery novel, all that was missing was his massive two-handed sword, though he had one in symbol. Charlie held it.

Genesis kissed through the scratchy nest of pubic hair that still clung to his hips, kissing Charlie’s fingers, Charlie’s eyes growing wide at how dirty this was becoming. She gripped Reza’s cock by the base tightly, Genesis running her tongue over Charlie’s thumb then along the top side of Reza’s shaft, then engulfing his covered glans with her open mouth and sucking. Charlie held it still, her eyes glued to the dirty action and she let out a long breathy gasp.

Genesis sucked for a while, and she was quite good at it. Head bobbing up and down, twisting her neck; Reza grew completely hard. When she pulled off, she covered Charlie's hand with her own, guiding it away and Charlie let go, the Latin woman taking over. She gripped Reza now, holding his big sword by the bottom and pointing it toward Charlie's mouth. She looked in Genesis's eyes as she opened it and lowered her mouth, Genesis aiming the big, bulbous end to pass between her teeth.

While Genesis held it, Charlie mimicked her expert moves, using her neck to roll her head up and down, her lips to form a nice tight seal around him. They alternated like that for a while, each taking a turn and holding it for one another.

Charlie was the first one to play with his balls. Getting bold. Her hand went down and lifted them, cradled them, ran her thumb over their shapes. When he was fully rigid, the skin looking tight, Reza groaned and pushed himself higher up the bed twisting at the waist, and finding the box of condoms that lay on the table next to the bed. They were Magnums, the larger ones, the XXLs. He peeled the wrapper and tossed it to the floor. Genesis took it from him and he let her, smiling, knowing what she would do, Jonny imagined. She placed the tip the rubber ring over the tip of his penis and told Charlie to watch what she did. She put her mouth over the condom, her eyes on Charlie's, Charlie watching with great interest. She bobbed her head up and down, pulled back and showed Charlie. She'd pushed the ring of the condom down as deep as she could go. Reza was too big for it to be fully pushed down, though if Genesis did that to him, she'd have the condom snugly in place right down to the base.

Charlie chuckled lightly and used her fingers to finish rolling the ring as far down as it would go. It hurt Jonny to see her having fun. In the kitchen he'd had his chance with her and failed. Now here she was with two people that weren't her husband, sharing in intimate time and getting off on it, having fun and laughing. He was left all alone on the chair to watch. But it

shouldn't hurt—if this were the situation they were in, shouldn't he be happy that she was having a good time? There were times recently when this had seemed very dire. His wife seemed to suffer under their brutish landlord. Tonight these two in bed with her seemed intent on giving her pleasure and teaching her some tricks. But with everything that Reza did there was always a hidden ulterior action. Why was she being groomed to do better? How much more but they expect from her?

Reza got up on his knees now and Charlie sat back and then lay down on the bed without having to be asked. She knew she was going to get fucked. She knew that condom was being put on that big dick because he was going to fuck her with it. Charlie almost seemed eager. That hurt his heart as well.

Now with her head and ginger mane spread out around at the foot of the bed, Charlie lay on her back with her knees up and her legs open. Reza got himself where he wanted to be, walking between her open thighs, that huge condom-covered dick wagging back and forth. Charlie put her hands up over her head, one coming down and biting on a finger as she waited, her eyes watching Reza's manhood. He hefted it, slapped lightly on the inside of each of her thighs, and Charlie spread herself wider. He lowered then, nestled the big blunt end with the reservoir tip into his wife's wet and eager folds.

Feeling it there, Charlie gasped. He got down low over top of her with his hands on the mattress under her armpits, and Charlie reached up, hugged his arms and scratched her nails across the muscles. She whispered, "I'm a little sore, can you be careful?"

He didn't answer her, watching her curiously, head tilting from side to side. The fact that he didn't give her a snide comment, some sort of reprimand for even making the request, seemed almost like acquiescence. He was a rigid and abrupt man. He eased himself inside her, and she tilted her chin up, her eyes closed, and she exhaled. Then he was fucking her,

feeding that big thing in and out of her, and Jonny swore he *was* being careful. Swore he *was* doing it to her the way she wanted rather than the way he wanted.

Reza studied her face as he fucked her, watching her reactions, slowing his pace, speeding up, almost as if he was feeding off of her reactions. It was more like making love than fucking. But just when Jonny's heart began to seize with a feeling of dread, the night got dirty again. Genesis scratched Reza's back, came around his body, walking on her knees until she was over Charlie's torso. Her back to Reza, she looked down her body as it straddled Charlie's face. She reached down and cupped the back of Charlie's head and brought it up between her legs. She reached over and snatched bundles of bedding and propped Charlie's head so it angled properly yet comfortably. Charlie put her tongue out and ran it along the woman's dark brown slit, flicking then at the bright shining diamond.

"That's it, Charlie, my little angel. Suck on that diamond, suck that diamond good ..." She lowered her hips and mashed her sex into Charlie's mouth.

So now here she was, his thin white wife laying on her back, Reza sitting on his heels, holding her legs up with his forearms hooked under her knees, her pretty feet bobbing as he fucked her. In front of him, a muscular Latin woman sat on her face. How was he not going to come tonight? He had his chance and he let Charlie down. While the two of them fucked his wife into wailing ecstasy, got her squeaking and moaning and crying, Genesis swiveling her hips and mashing Charlie's mouth, Jonny couldn't take it anymore. His hand slipped under the pillow, dipped under his waistband and reached down to hold himself. Just the feeling of his own hand made his whole body shake. It only took about ten strokes and he was jumping in his chair, sending out scorching hot jets that squirted in endless pulses. It was intense, his head pounding, his vision blurry as he watched the two of them make his wife come.

He wished she could have seen that ... wished she could have seen that,
in the end, she did make him come.

CHAPTER ELEVEN

BEFORE GOING up to the kitchen to make coffee, Jonny stood by the side of the bed and studied the naked bodies strewn over the battleground. Charlie lay upside down on the bed near the center but closer to the foot. She'd curled herself in a fetal position and her long, curly, apricot hair spread out over the bedsheets around her head like a halo. Bright morning light came in from the windows and lit up her highlights in gold. Her soft pink lips puffed with her gentle breaths as she slept. At her back, Genesis had spooned her, grabbing some white bedsheet and wrapping it around Charlie's middle. Her black hair spread out much like Charlie's. Reza lay on the other side of the cuddling girls, proudly spread out on his back and snored. Completely uncovered by bedding, Jonny looked his intimidating body over. All the muscle and all the hair, all the tattoos. That grotesque shaved squirrel laying in a wrinkled heap on his leg. The ruffled membranes of his foreskin looked reddened and swollen; abused probably from the rough anal sex with his wife's tight bottom. There was a little bright red spotting on the sheets and he worried that it might be from Charlie.

Now he was in the kitchen standing next to the expensive Italian espresso maker that Reza had brought into their home. It hissed and gurgled, and he rubbed viciously at his face with his hands. His clothing was fresh and new, having had to change after he'd finally released himself

inside his sweatpants. The volume had been staggering. He rushed into the bathroom while the three of them were still engaged in their sexual activity and felt his hot liquid turning cold as it dribbled down his legs all the way to his ankles. But he was comfortable now in new cotton clothing, standing barefoot and wondering why such a horrid display that he witnessed last night was somehow acceptable; somehow arousing.

Just then, through the pass-through, he saw that ginger mane pop up, then his wife's bare, naked body getting off the bed and trotting to the bathroom. She cupped her bottom with both her hands, bumping the door open with her shoulder then turning to close it. He saw a pained expression. His head rolled on his shoulders, and he worried for her.

While the other two slept, he decided he would go to her and share some of that intimacy the two of them had in the kitchen in the middle of the night, sharing their pizza and leftovers and being a fun little married couple again, before those demons awoke. He trotted down the stairs and across the foot of the bed, moving quietly, watching the two naked sleeping figures on the bed. He made it to the door and tapped on it gently.

Charlie's soft voice from behind: "Go away."

"It's me," he whispered, running his fingertips in zigzagging lines across the door, hoping she would open it for him, but knowing she wouldn't. The bathroom was Charlie's private space, and she didn't share.

When the door lever turned, he was stunned. He stepped back, frankly a little overwhelmed with disbelief. Charlie was there peeping through the gap, her face worried. "Come in, come in," she whispered. He slipped inside with her.

The two of them alone in the bathroom, he put his arms out, and she cuddled up against his chest. He hugged her. "Are you okay?" She shook her head no against his chest. "What's wrong?"

She stepped out of his embrace, hugging her arms around her chest and dipping slightly at the knees. She said, "My butt hurts so bad, so bad."

“It does?”

“Jonny, I think he damaged it. Will you take a look?”

His heart went out to her, she wasn't joking, she wasn't trying to be funny, she was upset. “Yeah, sure, I'll take a look.” He moved to the toilet seat and sat down on the closed lid. Charlie turned her back to him, sidestepped to his right side so that the lights above the vanity would shine on her.

On her tiptoes, she juttet her behind toward him. He opened her cheeks, lifted them with his thumbs and spread her wider.

“Ow, ow, Jonny, careful ...”

“I'm sorry, I'm being careful ...”

“I told him he was too big,” Charlie whispered into the shower.

Her usually pink anus looked a little red, and he imagined it must be sore, but there was no damage. There were no signs of blood, no signs of injury really, but he guessed she would have difficulty sitting down today.

“It looks okay, Charlie. I'm serious, it doesn't look bad.”

“Are you sure?”

“I think it just hurts, Charlie. I know it does, I know it must, but it looks okay back here. Want me to put some cream on it?”

She thought about it a moment. “Yes.”

He leaned to the side and pulled open the top drawer, found some topical ointment. With a pearl-sized dollop on the tip of his finger he massaged it into her little rosebud. She jumped at its cold feel.

“How's that?” he asked her.

“Better,” she said.

He still caressed her gently, saying, “You're just going to have to take it easy today. Maybe we could—”

There was a knock at the apartment door.

Together they both sighed in exasperation, Charlie saying, “Who's that?” And Jonny saying, “What now?”

Their eyes met each other, and they both gave a little laugh. Jonny said, "Let Reza get it, it's got to be one of his dumb friends."

"I hope not," Charlie said, frowning a little.

The knock came again. It was a little timid, a little soft for one of Reza's friends, who were usually fighters from the gym or street toughs.

Jonny stood up and kissed Charlie's shoulder. She lay her cheek on her collar and watched him do it. He kissed her forehead next. "Hold on," he told her. He opened the door a crack and saw Reza sitting up in bed, Genesis still lay on her side but she was stirring.

He said to him, "Can you get that?"

Reza stretched, scratched at his chest. He said, "What day is it?"

"It's Saturday. Saturday morning."

"Shoot," Reza said then yawned. "I think it's for you."

"What do you mean?"

Now he scratched his balls. "I think it might be Charlie's mother."

Every bit of his insides felt like they had just fallen down off a ladder, suspended from impact at the last moment by a twanging and straining bungee cord. His knees went watery, and he felt like his bladder wanted to release. His guts snapped upright again. "It's *who*?"

"Charlie's mother's coming on Saturday to stay. I forgot to tell you, I guess."

"Who is it? Who's here?" Charlie asked behind him as she brushed her teeth, not hearing a single thing Reza had said to him. Jonny's whole body went rigid. Charlie was going to lose her mind.

CHARLIE FELL to her knees when he told her. Her face blank, empty, distant; devoid. She looked awed, like she stood at the edge of the Grand Canyon witnessing its expansive endlessness, but looming in the distance

above it all, billowing thunderheads, churning storm clouds; the force of a destructive hurricane gusting her way.

“Charlie? Charlie? ...” He went to his knees before her, gripped her thin, bare arms. Her body was lifeless, he felt nothing in her limbs but tension.

“Easy, easy, Charlie ...” he said, and he guided her to sit down on her heels, put her back against the cupboards under the sink. He snatched down a towel hanging over the shower rod and put it around her shoulders, backing out of the bathroom and watching her.

At the foot of the bed now, he turned to Reza who was pulling his pants on, tucking his heavy manhood in the open V of his pants.

“Reza!” he hissed. “Reza? ... Look at me,” he said steadily.

Reza’s eyes came up to look at him coolly.

“Reza, I’m not joking around here. This is serious. Are you kidding?”

The knock came at the door again.

“Look, what do you want from me?—she called, and no one was here.”

“No one was here?”

“Charlie was at work—”

“No one was here? Reza, I’m *always* here. Are you serious? You did this on purpose?” He felt his hands shaking with rage now.

“Are you going to get the door, Jonny?” Reza said, shrugging his shirt over his shoulders and pushing his arms through the sleeves. The two of them locked eyes and Jonny had to face reality. Reza adjusted his shirt, the gaps between buttons gaping from the way his muscles pressed against the fabric. He was the same height as Jonny but had maybe sixty pounds on him or more. All muscle. Maybe he wasn’t ready to fight in the ring against other professionals, but he was assuredly man enough to end Jonny’s life in a matter of seconds. Jonny and Charlie owed him money. A lot of money. They were powerless before him. He owned them in every way. He fucked his wife right in front of him. Came in her mouth. Had done so much, Jonny feared his wife was starting to enjoy it. At one time she was disgusted, but

now it had changed. He was like a specimen on examination board, arms and legs outstretched to their furthest points, pins pressed through them.

“What are we going to do?” Jonny said in a weak voice, everything in him holding on to what little masculinity he had before this man, not showing him fear or worry but submitting just the same.

“I think you should start cleaning this place up,” Reza said with raised eyebrows. He looked around him and so did Jonny. On the far side of the bed Genesis had squeezed her curvy body into the tight pink thing that she came in. Her shoes were scattered on the floor. Next to the bed, in the space between the bathroom and the closet door, a Magnum XXL condom lay in a wriggling sloughed snakeskin, its reservoir tip field with pearly cream and much of the shaft as well. On the coffee table: a bong, a bottle of wine, four glasses. Charlie’s mother would kill her if she knew she had drank alcohol. And it didn’t end there. Genesis’s pink purse lay on its side, a dildo spilling out. There was a silver vibrator on the couch. A strap-on harness laying on the floor by the side table. Jonny was sure his heart had stopped beating. Everything in him was empty.

The bathroom door burst open and Charlie stumbled out. She had a big Dominican Republic beach towel wrapped around her shoulders like a shroud. She padded in with her bare legs and bare feet right up to Jonny. “Is it true ...? Is it true? Jonny ...”

“I think it is.”

Another knock at the door, still gentle but louder now.

Charlie’s eyes brimmed with tears and her lips formed a trembling ring until she sucked them in her mouth. She turned and hobbled to Reza. Her bare hands clutched the lapels of his suit jacket that he’d just put on. Shaking her head and looking in his eyes, she babbled: “You don’t even know ... You don’t even know ... You don’t even know ...”

Reza closed his hands over hers and gave her a stern face. When her trembling stopped, and she seems steadied, Reza flicked his chin to

Genesis, saying, “Clean up.”

Genesis did so immediately, going to the coffee table bending and thrusting things into her big bag.

Charlie was still frightened, but in a more controlled tone, she said, “You don’t even understand, Reza. You don’t know what you brought here. You don’t know what you’re doing to me.” She shook her head idly, struggling for words. Then looking to Genesis, she said, “You can’t be here wearing that.” Still struggling for words, she closed her mouth firm, and hung her head low.

Reza lifted her chin so she looked in his eyes again. He said, “Me fucking you doesn’t seem to be the incentive Jonny needs. I worry he likes watching me do it to you. You ever think that? This is incentive. Jonny is weak. I told you. Some men need strong women. Not me, but Jonny does for sure.”

Another knock at the door, this time much louder. If Charlie’s father was here, there was a good chance all of them may end up dead this afternoon. It literally felt the temperature of ice traveling from his heart down through his fingers and his scrotum turned to a raisin.

Reza looked to him and said, “Go get the door, Jonny. We’ll take care of down here.”

Jonny wanted to move to the door but was still frozen. His body was rigid, and he watched Reza as he hypnotized his wife, talking directly through her eyes.

“You’re not strong enough. You have to rule him or he goes stray. This is tough love, only I don’t love Jonny. I care about *you*. I always said that. If you believe in him, he needs to see the big picture, we thought he was getting it but I think your perverted husband is only focused on my big cock going into you.” He glanced up and saw Jonny still standing there. “Jonny, you still here?—go get the fucking door.”

IN THE BRIEF MOMENT—THAT seemed to last an hour—before Jonny opened the apartment door, standing with weight forward on one foot, hand resting on the lever, he prayed this was all still some mean ruse developed on the fly by Reza. He gulped a breath, opened the door.

It was no ruse.

On their threshold was Charlie's mother. A modest, steely eyed woman in her fifties. Mother of eight children, and who knows how many animals she'd birthed by hand; she was hard and intolerant of nonsense. She wore simple clothes; her silvering red hair pulled back from her face and tied in a bun; the sides clipped in place with bobby pins. Clothing was simple; clean and pressed, and devoid of frills. On the floor at her side was a worn suitcase.

With careful control, and without stuttering or shaky voice he managed: "Hello. Uh, hello, Mrs. Shooter."

"Good morning, Jonny. I hope I didn't wake you," she said with no expression.

"Wake me? Oh no, Mrs. Shooter," he glanced down, realizing his attire did not look ready to receive guests, and wasn't she, after all, invited? Brain firing into salvation mode, he brightened, politely asked her: "Please, come in." When she nodded, he dipped and grabbed her suitcase, saying, "Let me get your bag for you—we're awake, we're up, please, come in, have a seat here at the kitchen table. With her bag in hand he stood at the top of the stairs that led down to the living area, obstructing her view of whatever may be transpiring there.

"Have a seat, please. Have a seat there at the table," he said nodding with his chin. "Do you want a cup of tea? Can I make you some tea? Coffee? How was your trip?" With a glance over his shoulder, he saw bodies moving quickly in the living area, the three of them working silently.

Charlie's mother said, "It was fine, Jonny. Thank you for letting me stay." She moved to the kitchen table and sat down on one of the chairs.

“Charlie’s here?”

“She’s here,” Jonny said, another furtive glance over his shoulder before he stepped down backwards, leaving the kitchen and blocking the view with her suitcase pressed to his stomach. “I’ll just get her.”

But when he turned, Reza was there. Nonplussed, arrogant smile, motioning for Jonny to return to the kitchen. He saw Charlie and Genesis coming as well. Genesis looked grim, and Charlie looked grimmer, her lips pressed to a flat line and turned down in the corners. She looked like she might be sick.

“What’s going on? Did you—”

Reza gave a quick, aggravated shake of his head, frowned and nodded for Jonny to get up the stairs ahead of him, they were all coming up.

Back in the kitchen, Charlie’s mother rose from her chair, seeing people filing up the stairs. Past Reza, Jonny could see Genesis wearing one of Charlie’s winter overcoats. Held to her chest was her pink leather purse, stuffed with her goodies, closed at the top but almost bulging back open again.

Reza grunted to him, “Get the door, Jonny.” It made him stumble backward, and he dropped the suitcase, fumbling around before he managed to get his hand on the lever to the apartment door and open it. Charlie’s mother stepped forward as if she were to greet them all, but Reza hustled Genesis out into the hall. He said, “I’ll catch up with you at the office later,” took the door from Jonny and closed it behind her. Jonny looked over his shoulder to see Charlie’s mother with a bewildered look on her face.

She said, “It’s warm out for that overcoat.”

“She’s ... She works—”

It didn’t matter what lie he was going to come up with on the spot because now Charlie was at the top of the stairs and the two women, mother and daughter, met eyes. Charlie gave a slight curtsy and lowered her gaze.

“Come here, Charlie,” her mother said.

Charlie bit her lower lip, her hands clutched together in front of her, her posture slumped. She'd put on clothing, wearing a simple gray dress now, buttoned to her neck. The two women came together, Charlie's mother putting her arms around her daughter's back and holding her gently against her chest.

"How was your trip?" Charlie asked.

"It was all right, but you know how I feel about the city."

"I know, Mama," Charlie said.

Reza looked to Jonny, shook his head as if he expected something from him, then interrupted. "Sorry we weren't ready for you, Jonny called a meeting and it went late."

Still holding Charlie, Charlie's mother said "Were you the man I spoke to on the phone?"

"I am."

"And you work for Jonny?"

"With Jonny, I suppose." He smirked then, a mean little sparkle in his eyes. "We have contracts together."

Charlie's mother asked "You're business partners?"

Reza chuckled lightly, and said, "We *are* bound together. That's for sure. Wouldn't you say so, Jonny?"

Now Jonny did stammer. "I ... We—"

Reza rolled his eyes, interrupted, saying, "Why don't the three of you head down to the couch and catch up, and I'll give you some space."

CHAPTER TWELVE

CHARLIE MADE a pot of tea and she and Jonny and her mother sat in the living room. Jonny and Charlie on the couch facing her mother who sat in the same chair Reza used last night as he watched Genesis do awful things to this woman's daughter. They exchanged niceties, her mother did tell her of the trip from Kentucky to the city, told them of all the vulgarities she witnessed on the way. Charlie told her how well things were going at the library. Reza loomed in the kitchen, making himself an espresso, and definitely trying to overhear what was said.

When the pleasant talk was over, Charlie's mother leaned forward and Jonny realized she was about to get to the point. His hand shook, and he sat the cup onto the table.

With her fingers woven together, the sober woman lowered her eyes and prepared herself. When she looked up again, she looked around the apartment, gave a soft and silent sigh and said, "I'm glad to see that you're doing well. I wouldn't come to you like this if I didn't have to."

Charlie said, "Is something wrong?"

After another sigh, Charlie's mother said, "If it weren't for your letter I would never ask."

"What letter?" Jonny asked.

Charlie's mother said, "Charlie writes. She's very proud of you, Jonny. I can see why. I'm glad for your recent successes."

Something warm bumped his cold hand. He looked down and saw Charlie reaching to hold his. He hooked his fingers around hers and she gripped him. Charlie had written her mother that her husband was a big success now. And he supposed she told him about all the things that they were buying. The big TV, the big king-size bed, going out for dinner, all the grand things that were happening around here. Truth was he wasn't responsible for any of it. He'd only brought the bad. The luxuries in their life were ones that Charlie had earned. Earned on her back, the proverbial money laid out on the dresser when Reza was done. And somehow his beautiful and loving wife had twisted that into Jonny's merit. That was how much she believed in him. But a cold ball of dread formed just behind his breastbone. Maybe it was just hope. That was what Charlie *hoped*. It was what she hoped her husband could provide. And now she was lying and telling her mother things she wished were true. She had tangible evidence to show; Reza provided those things, and they existed in their life now ...

He didn't know if he should laugh or cry, embrace her and tell her how much he loved her, or fall before her and ask for her forgiveness.

Mrs. Shooter continued: "Your father is too proud to ask. And it pains me to go behind his back like this, but we do need help. And you're family. We would take you in in a heartbeat if you ever went astray."

"What kind of trouble?" Charlie gasped, and her hand on his clutched a painful grip.

"Your father would kill me if he heard me say this, but we need your help. You know your Papa is as strong as a bull, but he isn't the young man he used to be. He fell off the baler—"

"Oh no, Mama, is he okay?" Charlie whined, her face pinched with fright.

“He’s all right, Charlie. He’s all right. I told you he’s a tough one and you know it. Threw out his back. We got the boys on all the other chores, but we’re getting behind.”

“Is Papa hurting?”

Her mother said, “Not so he’d let you know. Out there all day just the same. Only he can’t do it as quick as he used to. I wanted to get some hands from the Work Center come and lend help, he won’t let me. Only he won’t let me because we can’t afford it. Wrong time of the year if you don’t mind me saying.” At this, she lowered her eyes shamefully.

“But what can we do?” Charlie asked, and Jonny wondered if she didn’t see that this was about money. Perhaps she thought her mama was going to ask Jonny to come down and pitch in, fix roofs, bale hay or whatever, put horseshoes on horses or something. There wasn’t anything they could do but one thing. At least, so her mother thought.

Mrs. Shooter’s eyes raised up again, she said, “I was hoping you could help out. Now you know I hate to come and do this sort of thing. And I wouldn’t ask if it wasn’t necessary. Charlie, I don’t want to see your Papa work himself into the grave just to prove he can.”

Charlie said, “I don’t want that either.”

Her mama continued, “If I didn’t get your letter, you saying how your family is doing well now, I wouldn’t come and ask.”

Charlie had caught on. “How much, Mama?”

With difficulty, her mother answered: “A few thousand, Charlie. Not more than ten. And I swear to the Lord, come the end of the season you get it back plus interest.”

Charlie’s head swiveled to face his, and they looked at one another. Charlie’s mouth was formed in a sorrowful O shape, her eyes trembling and wet.

But what could they do? They had no money to give. They had nothing to hock. All these trappings that Charlie had bragged to her mother about—

so unlike his modest wife—weren't theirs. And now, despite his wife's improper but hopeful boast, he was going to let her down again. Their tough mother came to him for money thinking he had it, and now she would know he didn't. He was a liar. Her daughter was a liar.

"Excuse me a moment," he said, cleared his throat, "more tea?"

Not waiting for an answer, he stepped around the coffee table and made his way to the kitchen, heard Charlie whispering his name behind him but didn't turn around.

"REZA..."

With a smirk, "What is it, Jonny?"

"You heard?"

"A little," he said, smirk still there, now adding a shrug.

"I need help."

"Already? I knew it was going to go this way, just didn't know it was going to be so soon."

"It was going to go this way how?"

"How's that game coming, Jonny? You make a million dollars yet?"

"It's only been a few weeks, you know that."

"I'm just surprised you can't see yet that it doesn't matter if it's going to be a couple weeks or a couple years. You're going to keep coming to me and there's only one thing you can offer that I want."

"I just need to know if you can help me."

"What did I tell you, Jonny? Anything you need. We just turn your dollars into days. Charlie's days."

"That's fine. You know that's fine. You don't need to rub it in. It's temporary. Mrs. Shooter'll pay us back."

Reza nudged his chin toward the steps, indicating for Jonny to get back down there. He followed behind. As Jonny took his spot sitting across from

Charlie's mother again, Charlie searched for his hand and squeezed it. Her warm hand had turned cold. Reza came around and took the chair next to Mrs. Shooter.

"I handle the banking for Jonny's company. I know this is a sensitive issue, so I'm just going to say something and you're not going to respond. We're going to get this done quick and we're not gonna talk about it anymore. I respect your pride. I'm going to issue a check that comes from one of Jonny's companies. It's a check for fifteen-thousand."

Charlie's mother's mouth opened as if to say something then she closed it.

"There is one important stipulation. Jonny wants you to know that you're family. The only way you can take it is if it doesn't come back. That's your daughter sitting next to him on the couch."

"Doesn't come back?" Charlie's mother asked. Just like her daughter, needing things clarified all the time. Only Charlie's mother held Reza's gaze with a stern expression.

"Jonny's money is Charlie's money. Charlie's money is your money. Charlie does a lot for Jonny, a lot more than she might even tell you." And then with that loaded statement filled with allusion, he smiled. "Where are you staying?"

"I stay on the couch when I'm here."

"Not anymore. You ever stayed at the Four Seasons?"

Charlie's mother kept his gaze still, face expressionless. She shook her head no.

"Well, it'll change your opinion of the city. I'm a have one of the company cars come by, take you there get you settled. You can wash up, meet these two for some lunch. I'll phone around and make sure your problem is taken care of."

Charlie's mother listened, her stoic face giving away a certain discomfort. Turning away from Reza, she faced Jonny and Charlie. Eyes

moving to Charlie, she whispered, “I *have* to pay it back.”

Charlie shook her head no. Charlie was the one who’d be paying it back.

Reza said, “A deal’s a deal, Mrs. Shooter.”

All four of them sat silently for a long moment, the room quiet. Charlie’s mother’s eyes traveled from Charlie to Jonny to Reza back to her daughter. Eventually she nodded. “Thank you,” she said.

AFTER THEY FINISHED THEIR TEA, making awkward small talk and enduring even more awkward silences, Reza called for Tate on his phone. Jonny stood with Reza in the living area while Charlie and her mother talked quietly in the kitchen. Jonny looked around. The bed had been made, all the evidence that had been left was cleared. But why had Reza let them come so close to calamity? Was it only so that he could be the hero—he could be the one to save Charlie’s mother?

He asked: “Did Mrs. Shooter say she was coming to borrow money?”

Reza said, “Doesn’t she seem too proud to do that?”

He nodded. “Why wouldn’t you just tell us she was coming?”

“To fuck with you.”

Jonny thought about it, his tongue working around the inside of his mouth. He said, “You can fuck with me all you want but don’t ever fuck with Charlie or her mother.”

“Or what?”

“Just don’t.”

Tate came then, walking into the kitchen and picking up Charlie’s mother’s suitcase. Jonny looked up there, saw his lovely wife standing with her mother. Her mother shook Tate’s hand, smiled at him. Handsome Tate. The man who just yesterday her sweet and innocent daughter jerked off into her T-shirt in the front seat of the very same car you were going to be driven

to The Four Seasons in. The fact that his mother-in-law was somehow dragged into Reza's disgusting game sickened him. Frightened him too, knowing all the ways that this could go wrong.

Charlie kissed her mother's cheeks, put hers out to be kissed. She said bye, Tate winked at her and escorted her mother down the hall to the elevators.

When the door was closed, Charlie thumped her head on it, then her weight fell forward and she slumped. Jonny went to her.

In his arms, she crumpled, curled so that her cheek pressed his chest.

She whispered, "Not my mother. He can't do things with my mother."

"He doesn't want to do things with your mother, Charlie, he—"

"Not those things, Jonny," she moaned. No, he knew not those things. Charlie's mother was a hard-nosed woman.

"I know, Charlie. I didn't mean—"

"I'm so ashamed. I'm so ashamed that my mother stepped foot in this den that I've created. This den of *iniquity* ..."

"Don't talk like that, Charlie. It's all right. We'll take care of it."

With her head resting on his chest, he saw her blinking eyes look across the living room, seeing Reza there. She let him go, trotted down the steps, and for a moment he thought she would strike their landlord. Instead, she stumbled to his feet and got on her knees.

"Please, Reza. Not my mother. Don't make her part of this. I'm begging you."

"You're the one that made her part of this, Charlie. You write to her?"

"So what if I did? I didn't see what would happen."

Reza gestured for her to get up, and she did. She stood weakly before him, her chin tilted up so she could look in his eyes. Now she said, "I can't do this anymore."

"Then pay me what you owe me."

"I can't do it. But I will. I know what I agreed to."

“Then what’s there to talk about? We just keep on keeping on.”

Charlie rested her hands on his muscular chest then they slowly closed around the fabric and she held him. “Can we have *more* money?”

It made him grin broadly. His eyes sparkled and the pointed tips of his mustache raised like snakes fangs. “*More* money?”

“Jonny needs help. I want him to have help.”

Jonny moaned, “Charlie ...”

Reza said, “What kind of help?”

“He needs help. People to code or whatever. People to help finish the game ...”

Reza nodded slowly. He said, “I like it. Jonny, tell me more.”

Jonny stepped down and joined them in the living room. His knees were weak, his vision a little hazy. He turned around a chair and sat down. “Charlie, don’t do this.”

Still holding onto Reza, she turned and looked at him over her shoulder. “It’s not more than what I’m already doing, Jonny. I’m gambling on you, but, baby, you’re my sure thing. It’s more money to owe him, but you’ll finish faster. You’ll finish and you’ll show him. And then ... It will all be over.”

“How much you need?” Reza asked, his voice low and gravelly.

Jonny sighed. After a long hesitation, he answered. “Two guys, maybe three.”

Reza thought about it, stroked Charlie’s hair while he did. Then he patted her on the bottom and motioned for her to turn around, holding out a hand to indicate her to the couch. Charlie sat down where last night Genesis had put her tongue up her anus, folded her hands in her lap and watched. Reza sat in the chair opposite Jonny, laced his fingers together, the two points of his index fingers under his chin. He breathed for a long while watching Jonny. He said, “Two guys. No more than 20K a month. I get ten percent of your game.”

“Ten percent? No way.”

“No way? That’s fine, Jonny. We’ll just keep on keeping on.”

“Five percent,” Jonny said.

“Ten percent, Jonny. Not negotiable.”

“That’s too much, Reza.”

“Then do it alone, take a year, take as long as you want. Six months my new place will be built, who knows where my relationship with your wife will be then. I can tell you right now, you’re still working on your dumb game six months from now she’s going to be moving in with me, much as she loves you. That’s how it’ll start. *I’m moving in with Reza, Jonny, just until you get your game done. It’ll give you more time to work, we’ll both be out of your hair, Jonny, I love you, kiss-kiss.* Then without you around, me fucking those screams out of her every night, next you’ll hear from her is divorce papers in the mail.”

“That’s ridiculous,” Charlie said.

“We’ll see if it is.”

“Can I think about it?” Jonny said—as soon as the words left his mouth knowing that he just exposed his throat to this predator.

Reza smiled. “Take as long as you want, Jonny. Take the whole six months. I’m having a great time. And your wife might complain to you behind my back, but she’s loving every minute between my bedsheets.”

Jonny hoped that Charlie would protest, but she merely lowered her eyes.

He said, “I have to get out of here. I haven’t been outside in days. I just have to get out of here ...”

Charlie stood up, whispered his name, “Jonny ... Jonny, let me come with you.”

He looked at her, the most important thing he had, the only thing of value. He nodded his head rapidly and held his hand out to her and she took it.

CHAPTER THIRTEEN

TOGETHER THEY WANDERED the city streets for a while. Not sure how long, more than half an hour. Nothing was said, but they stayed close together. He wasn't mad at her, she wasn't mad at him, both of them just needed to do a lot of thinking. They ended up at the city museum and neither of them had to ask—they mounted the marble steps, paid the twenty bucks each to get in (why not, these days they always seemed to have pocket money), and wandered the halls of displays from ancient Rome. Still wordless, Charlie took his hand, and they stopped at every diorama to examine the ancient artifacts. One time she even kissed his shoulder then rested her cheek there.

Jonny's actions had created a real hydra. An impossibly complex situation. The more he struggled, the more Charlie struggled, the more they became stuck. There was a way out, he knew there was, but they wedged themselves very tightly in Reza's pronged trap. Somehow, he would get them out.

Charlie's mother hated cell phones, didn't have one, but she called from the hotel room to ask them to have a late lunch with her. Charlie let his hand go, wandered to where it was quiet and she wouldn't bother anyone with her talking. Jonny stood under a marble statue of Alexander the Great and watched her with his hands in his pockets from a distance. Leaning against

the wall, her face hidden under her mane of pale ginger hair, one hand cupped over the ear on the opposite side of the phone. She closed off the call and rejoined him.

He asked her, “What did she think of the room?” It was all he could think of about Charlie’s mother right now. Experiencing the luxuries of life, thinking it was Jonny’s success, not knowing it was Reza’s money earned by her daughter’s submissive sexual acts.

Charlie answered, “She said it was ... *opulent*.” And with no further explanation, Jonny knew coming from that simple woman the word *opulent* wasn’t a compliment. It was a castigation of sorts. But despite that, he got a glimpse of the happiness those luxuries would give his wife if he were to provide them.

At their late lunch, being seated after two-thirty in the hotel’s ground floor Michelin-star restaurant that looked out onto bustling Frobisher Avenue, Charlie elaborated to her mother Jonny’s recent success. She outlined all the hard work he’d done, all that true, talked about the sacrifices he made, the hours he kept, his dedication. Again, all true. Her smile though, seemed to be brought by the reward that came with Jonny’s effort. That was a lie. For now. And that was Jonny’s dilemma. Was Charlie’s ... *effervescence* ... provoked by the trappings of success or provoked by her admiration for her husband’s dedication? He’d like to think she recognized how he laid it on the line to save her, and then a darker part of him thought there was an even darker part of her that liked spending Reza’s money. She still kept those shoes, and one night wore them with nothing else while in bed with Reza. Reza asked her to do it, and she complied—Jonny carefully measuring her compliance, trying to gauge what it would mean. And there was a frightening possibility that it could be both. She could love Jonny and love how he broke his back for her, and she could also at the same time love the gifts she received from their menacing landlord. And with disgusting

certitude he realized she might like his other gifts. Not just his size, but his mastery over her orgasm.

Charlie's mother was happy for her daughter, but there was a wariness there. She wasn't a stupid woman, and she must sense danger from Reza. But in a way, now she was on his hook, too. Fifteen-thousand dollars in her pocket book—her showing them that she received the money, a check delivered to her hotel room while Jonny and Charlie had wandered the museum. Now, this tough farmer wouldn't spread her legs for that man in a million years, but Reza'd found a way to make her submit in another way.

They had a fantastic lunch together—at least the food was good. Club sandwiches, Waldorf salad, iced tea and coffee, apple pie for dessert. Jonny stayed silent while Charlie's mother filled her daughter in on all she was missing back at the Shooter compound. Jonny twisted his cloth napkin into a tight knot without realizing, then hid it away, worried he would get in trouble. Worried the knot was so tight the busboy couldn't untie it. The whole while he sat and listened, the food he'd eaten became heavier and heavier, condensing to the weight of liquid metal in his stomach. When Charlie happily paid for the meal with Reza's credit card, he thought it might all come back up again.

THEY WALKED BACK to the apartment from The Four Seasons hand-in-hand. Silent again, and despite the dread—the swaying anvil held over their heads by a fraying rope—he found a sense of warmth and togetherness with his wife.

It was just after five o'clock that they made it back and found themselves alone in the apartment. Which was fine with Jonny. Better than fine. If only this were the way it always was. Money in the bank, work to do on his computer, Charlie by his side, the two of them alone in the place where they lived. Someday it would be like that, someday they would travel

the length of this disastrous ellipse and find themselves back at the start and in a much better position.

Shoes off and enjoying the silence of their empty abode, they both came and flopped down on the couch. He looked across the room as Charlie lay against his side and rested her head on his chest, looked at his workstation, its blank gray eyes. He needed to light those eyes up, make some magic, finish their contract with their landlord.

They saw something together, ignored it together ...

Dead center on the king-size bed sat a small gift-wrapped box. Vibrant turquoise paper and a bright blue ribbon crossing it with an elaborate bundled bow atop. They ignored it, but its presence got Jonny chewing the inside of his mouth. What now?

Charlie's phone rang, and she withdrew it from the pocket of her simple gray farm dress she put on because her mother had arrived. Looked at the screen, and Jonny saw the call came from Reza. She sat upright, and he rested the palm of his hand in the center of her back as she answered.

"Yeah ... Hi ... Uh-huh, we did ..."

Jonny rubbed his hand in a circle.

"We had lunch. We ... Oh yeah? ... She did ... Yeah, she got it. She showed us."

Jonny rolled his eyes, kept his hand moving in that easy circle and feeling her wonderful and slim body under his hand.

"Yeah, I see it ... huh? ... I will ... Where are you? ... What time? ... Uh-huh ..."

Now she stood up, and Jonny rested his hand on his thigh. She walked away from him, her feet moving carefully around the furniture, moved to the bed and sat herself down on it.

"Yes. I know. It's not ... I know that ... I do ... What? ... You know I do ... uh-huh, yeah ..."

Her free hand reached to the side and brought the box to her lap. While she continued with her grunts of affirmation, her submissive speech to their dominant master, she undid the bow at the top and the ribbon wrapping the box fell away. She lifted the lid.

“It’s what? ... What’s that? ... Okay ...”

She reached in and pulled out a sheet of paper pinched between thumb and forefinger. “Uh-huh, Yes, I’m reading it ... Hold on ...” Charlie read the paper while her feet gently kicked at the side of the bed. “Oh,” was what she said as she set the paper back down.

Her face showed worry, and she averted her eyes from Jonny. She ran a hand through her shaggy hair while the box still sat on her lap. “Tell me again ... How much ... Yes, I know, I read it ... I just don’t understand ...” She shook her head now and rolled her eyes. “I can read, you know I can read.”

Now Jonny rolled *his* eyes and looked away. The dread had formed again, churning that liquid metal that still sat in his stomach and condensing it to the size and hardness of a cannonball.

“Yes. I know. I’ll tell him ... No, I know ... I *know* that, I’ll tell him. Bye.” She closed the call and set her phone down on the bed.

“Now what?” he asked.

She didn’t look at him for a while, stayed quiet, her two hands cupped around the turquoise box as her heels thumped at the side of the bed and she stared at the floor. He let her think, knew it was going to be bad anyway, and finally she said, “He’s willing to make a deal.”

“What kind of deal?”

She scratched her upper lip with the even white row of her bottom teeth, ran her tongue from side to side, her eyes turned up to look at the ceiling. “What we were talking about this morning.”

“He’ll pay for some help?”

“He will.”

“I thought he said it wasn’t negotiable.”

“I guess it *is* negotiable,” she sighed.

“What’s the deal?”

“He’ll take the five percent you offered.”

“He will? And he’ll pay for staff?” This was good news. He sat forward on the couch, rested his forearms on his knees.

Charlie nodded. “He will. He’ll take five percent and he’ll pay for staff on a month-by-month basis.” Now she looked around the room again, sighed, finally met his eyes. “Can you come here?” she said and patted the space next to her.

“What’s in the box?” he asked as he got up and took a few steps.

“Sit here,” she said and patted the bed again. He sat down next to her and folded his hands in his lap, looked at her. She was tense, chewing the inside of her mouth as he would do. Her eyes were open, wide and innocent, but her brow had lowered with concern.

“What’s in the box, Charlie?” he asked again.

She dipped her chin down and looked away, but reached into the small square box and pulled out a curved stainless steel wire tube with dangling rings and a small lock; it looked like a medical device.

“What’s that?” he asked her, mimicking her look of concern, his own brow lowered.

“It’s a cage. For a penis.” She ran her finger into one end of the tube and said, “you put your penis in here and then close this ring around ...” She closed her eyes and sighed. “... Your *balls*,” she whispered.

“Why?” he said. “Reza wants to wear that?”

“Not Reza. You.” She examined it, Jonny thinking she was gauging its size, even him recognizing now that Reza’s flaccid penis would not fit inside it. “Why would I wear it?”

Teeth nibbling at the inside of her lip, she stared at him, then said, “It’s a chastity cage, Jonny.”

“Chastity?”

“So you can’t use your penis.”

His mouth opened to say something, but nothing came out. His eyes darted in quick vectors around the room, his brain scrambling to make sense of this. “What’s ... *What’s* the deal?”

CHAPTER FOURTEEN

CHARLIE TOOK A DEEP BREATH, stalled by looking down and glancing at the piece of paper, re-reading it. She said, “He takes five percent, and every month you wear this,” she said, wiggling the cage, “he will fund two employees for thirty days. Only contracts, no employment. Contracts renewed on a thirty-day basis, depending on whether you’ve been a good ...” Now she frowned, and tilted her head, averted her eyes. “... *Cuck* boy or not.”

“What?” he chuckled with disbelief. “I can’t take it off?”

“Twice a month. You get it off twice a month for one hour. The 14th and 28th.”

“That’s crazy. He’s crazy ...” Jonny said, staring blankly across the room.

Charlie softly said: “It’s a sacrifice, Jonny.”

Her meaning was received. It was a sacrifice far less than the sacrifice she made.

“Can I *do* that?” he asked himself out loud. Then glancing to Charlie, he asked, “Do you *want* me to do that?”

“It would mean you would get help.”

“Yeah,” he agreed, eyes still lazy and unfocused. “I could get help. But I can’t ... *do* ... anything ...?”

“It hasn’t been working ...”

It was like she punched him in the stomach. “My penis? You don’t think it’s working?”

“Easy, Jonny. You know what I mean. It hasn’t been so good between us since this started.”

“Jesus, Charlie,” he said, venturing into profanity that went in an area she didn’t like, taking the Lord’s name in vain and all. But this was serious shit. He stood up, walked in a circle at the side of the bed. “You don’t think my penis works?”

“I know it’s difficult. I know it must be hard to watch me with ... him.”

“My penis *works*, Charlie. Jesus, fuck.” He ran his hands through his hair and vigorously scratched at his scalp.

“You can take it off twice a month, Jonny.”

“Twice a month?” he said.

“It better work when it comes off, Jonny,” she said and gave him a weak smile.

“It will, Charlie. It works, you know it works. My head is all messed up. This whole thing is crushing me, but we’ll get through it, right?”

Would they get through it? Sure, this was a sacrifice on his part now, but it would widen the gap between him and Charlie. It created a void just watching her have sex with another man, now that void would grow wider if he continued to watch her have sex with this other man but couldn’t partake himself. Then again, there was some truth to the difficulties he had with her recently.

Charlie gave a gentle head nod. “We can get through *anything*,” she said.

He left her alone then, walked around the foot of the bed and came to stand in front of his workstation, two hands curled over the head rest of the chair that he had Reza buy him—on his wife’s time. What the fuck was happening?

What had started out as a blow job in trade for some rent money had somehow become a full transference of all his debts to one lone and frightening man. That \$80,000 that he owed was passed over with the lure of saving \$30,000 in interest charges. Who would turn down an interest-free loan? Charlie was no dummy, but she *was* naïve. And this was exactly what Reza had wanted. A no-interest loan that kept getting more principal tacked onto it. Somehow over the course of this weekend Jonny himself had added maybe \$120,000 to what Reza was owed, money to pay for help. A gamble. He'd give up five percent of his company for it and Charlie would pay in the meantime, laying on her back with her legs open. And she would do it until she couldn't stand it anymore. And that might be Reza's ultimate game. To take Charlie away from him. Just for fun. But that *wasn't* going to happen.

Reza offered a chance at getting out of this with Jonny's own sexual servitude—and he would do it. He would let his genitals be trapped in a cage until this was over. All that Charlie had done for them, he could chip in as well. It wouldn't be easy, but it would be a lot easier than what his wife was doing.

It would be six months before Reza's house was built and they would see what happened then. When Reza moved out, he assumed there would be money still owed, but Jonny knew it was just a matter of time before he would show them all. With that added debt, the money paid to contractors, maybe, just maybe, he would stick it in Reza's face even before the six months were up.

Still, a horrible scenario. That was the best hope he had, and it still meant that Reza would be fucking his wife every night for the next one-hundred-eighty days. And it wasn't usually just once a night. Sometimes twice, sometimes three times. There had been times it was four and even five. That meant Reza could fuck Charlie another five-hundred times before it was over.

What would be left of his wife then?

Charlie hugged him from behind, her two hands coming around his waist, her fingernails scratching at his chest. He thumped his fist on the chair's headrest, doing it hard and making the chair jump. Charlie stepped back.

"This is crazy, Charlie. I want to do it. I want to do it because *you've* done so much. But it's so *crazy*."

"You don't have to," she said softly, and he turned to see her wringing her hands together, her eyes getting wet.

"He's getting in my head, Charlie."

"Don't let him, Jonny."

"I lost my whole day of work yesterday. Then the whole night, watching you and that woman and him. Then today, he ruins my whole day. My focus is completely gone. I have so much to do and he keeps getting in the way. I want to do what's right, but I feel like we're just getting ourselves wedged tighter in his trap, we're falling for everything he's setting up."

Charlie nodded.

He continued: "I have to get back to work, and I'm looking at my computer and it just feels like everything is uphill again. I lost my momentum, he's shaking me ..."

"Don't let him get in your head, Jonny. Don't let him win. Wear it. If you wear it, you can't think about *it*. *It's* off the table."

"*You're* off the table. You'll be his entirely."

"I'll always be here for you, Jonny. If I'm his, then you can work. You won't be distracted. Then you'll have your focus."

"And you'll be okay if I wear this thing? You'll be okay if my penis is trapped inside it?"

"I know it won't be easy, Jonny. I know it. None of this is easy, but remember we're in it together. I do what I do, you do what you do, we'll come out okay on the other side. It's a cage, but it's just wire. You can pee.

It's pretty small, I don't think you can get hard with it on, but I guess that's the point, isn't it?"

"Yeah, I think that's the point," he said. Of course it's the point. "Okay. For you, Charlie. I'll wear it for you."

"Don't do it for me, Jonny."

"I'm doing it for *us*. I'm doing it for the money that would get me the stuff that will build my game, and when it's done, shove it all back in that asshole's face."

It made his wife smile. Just a small tug at the corner of one side of her lopsided lips, but it meant everything to him. He loved to see that glimmer in her eye. Pride. Pride in her husband.

He said, "One time before it goes on?"

"One time what? You mean get in bed?"

He stepped to her and put his hands on her waist. "One time before it goes on, Charlie. Come to bed with me."

She shied away from him, shaking her head from side to side, and looking in his eyes. "Reza said we can't. It started already."

"He said that on the phone?"

"He said you would ask before it went on. He said we can't."

"How would he know?"

"Just obey the rules, Jonny. You know what I said. We can't make it difficult. We can't resist him all the time. It would be so easy for him to watch us. How did he know to call when we got home, tell me to open the box on the bed?"

The pain in his stomach told him how difficult this would be. Just that simple rejection, knowing that he wouldn't be able to have her (and he hadn't even put the damn thing on yet) was already constricting his chest and making him feel like he couldn't breathe. He kept his expression bright. "Okay. Give it to me, I'll go in the bathroom."

"I have to put it on you, Jonny," she said.

“Do you know how it goes on?” he asked, reaching down to grab the sheet of paper that was inside the box, laying on the bed next to it.

Charlie scrambled, tried to snatch it away before he read it. Now they stood together face-to-face, Charlie’s hands clasped together over her chest as he read the paper. It outlined the instructions, outlined the parameters of the agreement, detailing the five percent ownership and the dual monthly contracts for employees. Underneath it, in that gorilla’s blocky grade-school printing, he’d added:

I described Jonny’s dick to the girl at the
store and GOOD NEWS! He doesn’t take the
smallest size. You can tell him there are men
with even smaller dicks than him, it might
cheer him up.

“Can I put it on you now?” she asked, trying to change the subject.

“Okay,” he said, his voice a dry squeak. She picked up the cage, and he unbuckled his belt.

“You want to sit down?” she asked.

“Yeah, please. I feel a little lightheaded.”

She unbuttoned his pants and did down his zipper, let them fall to his knees and guided him to sit on the edge of the bed, his legs spread by the corner. She looked at the directions again though it seemed pretty straightforward. “Don’t get hard or anything, Jonny,” she said.

“I won’t,” he said, in fact having the opposite problem. The impending imprisonment had frightened his genitals. His penis had shrunken, and his testicles had climbed high. He watched as Charlie got on her knees, squatting down, then guiding the tip of his penis into the cage. With the point of her index finger, she popped each of his testicles through a tight

stainless steel loop, then cinched it tighter bringing two open hasps together and clasp them closed with the small padlock.

“Is it comfortable?” she asked him.

“It’s a little cold. I guess it’ll warm up.”

“Does it hurt your balls?”

“No. It feels a little weird, but it’s not uncomfortable.”

“Okay,” she said speculatively, her eyes going over her handiwork, watching how her husband’s genitals were now closed away from her. She pulled over the turquoise box and withdrew a very small key, inserted in the lock and twisted it closed.

“Don’t lose that key,” he told her.

“Oh my gosh, can you imagine?” She giggled, covered her mouth, got serious again. “I won’t, Jonny.”

It felt uncomfortable for her to see him like this, so he motioned for her to step back then he stood, pulled his pants up and did up his belt.

“Does it feel okay? Honestly, Jonny, does it feel all right?”

He moved his hips from side to side, eyes turned up, checking for discomfort. A certain calm had actually eased through him now. He told her. “Yes. I’m okay, Charlie. It’s crazy. I feel more focused already. Like there’s this weight that’s been lifted off me. It just removed an option that was distracting me.”

“I’m a distracting option?”

“Yes, you are,” he said, then kissed her neck.

“But now you can’t have me,” she whispered. The sound of her voice so close to his ear, so sibilant and enticing, caused a stirring that pressed against his wire confinement. It was a teasing of the difficulties that may come. He pushed himself away from her, said, “Be careful, I don’t want to make this thing uncomfortable.”

“Sorry,” she laughed.

They stood in front of each other again for a long moment, both of them feeling out this new arrangement. Him standing there with a certain tightness between his legs, knowing it was impossible for it to be fulfilled; his wife standing facing him, knowing that nothing would transpire between them today, or for a while.

“Okay,” he said at last. “Yeah, okay, I guess ... I want to get to work.”

Charlie repeated: “You get back to work, Jonny.” That proud smile had returned.

“I’m going to send out some work invites. By tomorrow afternoon I want to have two people banging out my code. I’m going to get this shit done, Charlie.”

“Want me to make you some coffee?”

“Make me some coffee, that’s right, I’m going to get cracking.” Their eyes met, and he pushed away the desire to kiss her lips, instead weaving his fingers together, turning his hands inside out and cracking his knuckles to punctuate his statement.

“I want to kiss you so bad right now, but I’m not going to,” Charlie said to him, her chest stuck out and her chin up proudly.

They *could* get through this. Together they could beat Reza.

As Charlie brewed espresso from Reza’s machine Jonny already sent out notice on Job-Force that he was looking for talent, and now he had a console up, banging out code.

The machine hissed and chugged from the kitchen and a dread worked over him. Soon Reza would return to the apartment for the night. This was his home for the interim and now essentially Charlie was *his* wife—because she certainly wouldn’t be Jonny’s.

The idea of Charlie on her back as Reza gorilla-fucked her cinched his device tighter on him and he realized the potential danger here. How could he watch it happen and not get hard? He had no room to get hard. Worst of all: after Reza fucked her and made his Charlie come, now he couldn’t meet

her in the kitchen in secret and have a little dirty one-on-one while the beast slept. They couldn't have a quick one in the time between Charlie getting off work and Reza coming home. His stomach tightened, and he swallowed dryly.

This could be a big mistake.

It could be, but he would do it for that woman he loved. He gritted his teeth and typed faster.

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